

“A Study on the Government, NGO and CBO Initiatives for Rural Development in Bangladesh”

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Abstract

Enhancing the quality of life and economic prospects in rural regions involves a range of initiatives falling under the umbrella of rural development. These areas often grapple with challenges such as insufficient infrastructure, limited access to education and healthcare, factors that can perpetuate poverty and hinder overall progress. Beyond improving local conditions, rural development plays a vital role in contributing to global sustainability goals. The vast majority of people live in rural areas, and agriculture accounts for a sizable portion of Bangladesh's economy. As a result, rural populations in Bangladesh face a variety of problems. These challenges underscore the vital role of rural development in advancing sustainable development objectives. The discussion highlights diverse endeavors undertaken by governmental bodies, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and community-based organizations (CBOs). Nevertheless, the discussion also identifies hurdles encompassing resource accessibility, coordination, and cultural nuances. A thorough investigation is crucial to understand the various efforts made by government, NGOs, and CBOs in rural development, assessing their effectiveness and the obstacles they encounter. Additionally, gathering public feedback on these initiatives can offer valuable insights into their strengths and weaknesses, aiding informed policymaking and the development of future strategies. Major findings highlight the absence of agricultural support in a favorable farming environment, inadequate local employment opportunities leading to migration, dominance of private healthcare, gender inequality, obstacles in accessing microfinance, ignorance of maintenance, and partnership difficulties. These results emphasize the necessity for specific interventions and policy enhancements in the area.

Table of Contents

Acknowledgement.....	ii
Abstract.....	iii
Table of Contents.....	iv
List of Tables.....	vi
List of Figures.....	vi
List of Maps.....	vii
List of Abbreviation.....	viii
Chapter 1: Introduction.....	1-3
1.1 Background of the Study.....	1
1.2 Objective of the Study.....	2
1.3 Rationale of the Study.....	2
1.4 Scopes and Limitations of the Study.....	2
Chapter 2: Literature Review.....	3-9
2.1 Terminologies	3
2.2 Development Authorities.....	4
2.2.1 Government Organization (GO).....	4
2.2.2 Private Organizations (NGO, CBO).....	4
2.2.3 Partnership/ Collaboration.....	5
2.3 Rural Development in Global Context.....	5
2.3.1 Case study.....	6
2.4 Rural Development in Bangladesh Context.....	7
2.4.1 Policies and Plans	7
2.4.2 Case study.....	8
Chapter 3: Methodology.....	9-12
3.1 Selection of Study Area.....	9
3.2 . Preparation of Coordination Schema, Questionnaire, KII and FGD Question...9	
3.2.1. Coordination Schema Preparation.....	9
3.2.2. Questionnaire Preparation.....	10
3.2.3 KII and FGD . Question Preparation.....	10

3.3 Data Collection.....	10
3.3.1. Primary Data Collection.....	10
3.3.2. Secondary Data Collection.....	10
3.4 Data Analysis.....	11
3.4.1 Quantitative Analysis.....	11
3.4.2 Qualitative Analysis.....	11
Chapter 4: Study Area Profile.....	12-15
4.1. Location of Study Area.....	12
4.2. Demographic and Socio-economic Profile.....	13
4.2.1 Gender and Age.....	13
4.2.2 Educational Qualification.....	14
4.2.3 Occupation and Income.....	14
4.3. Community Facilities and Infrastructures	14
4.3.1 Existing condition.....	14
4.3.2 Satisfaction of community regarding facilities.....	15
Chapter 5: Rural Development Initiatives	16-20
5.1 Involved Authorities.....	16
5.1.1 Framework.....	16
5.1.2 Sectoral Contribution.....	17
5.1.3 Community Participation.....	18
5.1.4 Collaboration.....	20
Chapter 6: Community Perception Analysis	20-26
6.1 Impact on community.....	20
6.1.1 Livelihood and Employment.....	20
6.1.2 Basic Facilities and Infrastructure.....	22
6.1.3 Empowerment.....	24
6.2 Challenge and Inconvenience	25
6.3 Authority Preference.....	26
Chapter 7: Major Findings and Recommendation	26-29
7.1 Major Findings.....	26

7.2 Policy Recommendation.....	28
7.2.1 Community based Recommendation.....	28
7.2.2 Findings based Recommendation.....	28
Chapter 8: Conclusion.....	29-30
Reference.....	xi
Appendix A.....	xii-xiv
Appendix B.....	xvii-xviii
Appendix C.....	xix
Appendix D.....	xxiii-xxxi

List of Tables

Table- 4.1: Table showing the areas of selected study areas.....	13
Table- 4.2: Table showing the demographic profile of each study area (Upazilla).....	13
Table- 4.3: Table showing the literacy rate of each study area (Upazilla).....	14
Table 7.1: Recommendation of community in percentage.....	28
Table- C.1: Table showing community facilities available in each study area (Upazilla)...	xxii
Table D.1 Summary of FGD and KII.....	xxiii
Table D.2: Summary of Rural Development Initiatives.....	xxv

List of Maps

Map 4.1: Maps showing the Districts and Upazilas that have been selected as study areas...	12
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List of Figures

Figure 3.1: Flow diagram of the entire study process	12
Figure 4.1: Bar diagram showing satisfaction level of existing facilities.....	15
Figure 5.1: Graph showing contribution GO, NGO, CBO and Partnership initiatives in different sectors.....	17
Figure 5.2: Source of Information among initiative authorities.....	18
Figure 5.3: Involve level among respondents.....	19
Figure 6.1: Graph showing satisfaction regarding employment in different areas.....	21
Figure 6.2: Graph showing satisfaction regarding training facilities in different areas.....	22
Figure 6.3: Graph showing satisfaction regarding health initiatives of GO, NGO.....	23
Figure 6.4: Graph showing satisfaction of women regarding women empowerment initiatives of GO and NGO.....	25
Figure 6.5: Challenges of GO, NGO, CBO and Partnership Projects.....	25
Figure 6.6: Preferable authority in different distrites.....	26
Figure C.1: Graph showing gender distribution of study area.....	xix
Figure C.2: Graph showing age distribution of study area.....	xix
Figure C.3: Graph showing overall and gender wise educational qualification.....	xx
Figure C.4: Graph showing district wise occupation distribution of study area.....	xx
Figure C.5: Graph showing gender wise occupation distribution of study area.....	xxi
Figure C.6: Graph showing income distribution of study area.....	xxi

List of Abbreviation

BBS- Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics

BRDB- Bangladesh Rural Development Board

NGO- Non-governmental organizations

CBO-Community-based. Organizations

SDG- Sustainable Development Goals

NRDP- National Rural Development Policy

RERMP- Rural Employment and Road Maintenance Program

REDWP- The Rural Employment and Decent Work Project

MHU- The Mobile Healthcare Unit

RISE- The Rural Infrastructure Services and Employment

KII- Key Informant Interview

FGD- Focused Group Discussion

LGED- Local Government Engineering Department

Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

Rural development encompasses multifaceted efforts to enhance the quality of life and economic prospects of people residing in rural areas. These regions often face challenges such as limited access to education, healthcare, and infrastructure, which can perpetuate poverty and hinder overall progress. Development in rural areas is crucial not only for local well-being but also for achieving global sustainable development goals. Globally, SDG 11 highlights the need to eradicate poverty in all its forms, underscoring the importance of rural development as a means to achieve this goal (United Nations, n.d.).

Rural development is a critical aspect of sustainable national progress, particularly in countries like Bangladesh where a significant portion of the population resides in rural areas with a predominantly agrarian economy. Effective rural development is imperative for addressing poverty and fostering inclusive growth (World Bank, 2020). The National Rural Development Policy (2001) in Bangladesh aims to uplift rural living standards and develop human resources, aligning with constitutional obligations. Over the years, various entities, including the government, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and community-based organizations (CBOs), have taken initiatives to address the multifaceted challenges faced by rural communities. These initiatives aim to improve livelihoods, alleviate poverty, enhance infrastructure, and promote socio-economic development. aimed at uplifting rural areas. The government of Bangladesh has rolled out numerous policies, programs, and projects to foster rural development. These initiatives often involve infrastructure development, agricultural support, education, healthcare, and skill enhancement. For instance, government initiatives like the "Bangladesh Rural Development Board" (BRDB) have been pivotal in driving various development projects at the grassroots level (Islam et., al., 2003) .In addition to government efforts, NGOs and CBOs have emerged as key players in rural development. Organizations like BRAC, Grameen Bank, and ASA have been actively involved in implementing innovative and community-focused programs. These organizations often operate with a bottom-up approach, involving local communities in decision-making and project execution. Microfinance programs, women's empowerment projects, and vocational training initiatives are some examples of the interventions carried out by NGOs and CBOs. (Islam, 2017; Rubin, 1993)

While these initiatives have shown promising results, challenges remain. Access to resources, effective coordination, sustainability, and cultural considerations are among the factors that influence the outcomes of rural development initiatives in Bangladesh. Therefore, a comprehensive study that explores different initiatives taken by and examines the scope, effectiveness, and challenges faced by government, NGOs, and CBO initiatives in rural development is essential. Moreover, a study on people's perception of those initiatives can provide valuable insights into the strengths and limitations of these interventions, contributing to informed policy-making and the formulation of future development strategies.

1.2 Objectives of the Study

Every study is based on some objectives. The objectives of the study are-

- To explore the GO, NGO, and Community initiatives for rural development in Bangladesh
- To investigate the community's perception regarding the impacts of the initiatives.

1.3 Rationale of the Study

In nations like Bangladesh, where a sizable majority of the population lives in rural areas with a predominately agrarian economy, rural development is a crucial component of sustained national prosperity. Researches concerning with government initiatives in the rural sector has been relatively limited, with most studies focusing on NGO-based efforts. Additionally, case studies examining Community-Based Organizations (CBOs) have mostly been conducted in foreign contexts. While individual studies on CBOs, NGOs, and government initiatives exist, only a few have attempted to comprehensively analyze and compare all these initiatives together. Furthermore, there is a lack of studies that effectively explore community perceptions of rural development projects implemented by different authorities. Moreover, collaboration or partnership projects between different authorities are scarce in the existing literature. Addressing these gaps in research this study could provide valuable insights into rural development strategies and outcomes.

1.4 Scopes and Limitations of the Study

The study holds significant scope as it examines the development patterns and influencing factors in rural areas through government, non-government, and community-based organizations. The

findings will empower responsible authorities to enhance current efforts, offering insights into local participation levels and actionable recommendations. Additionally, the study facilitates comprehension of partnership challenges and opportunities among diverse organizations. Its outcomes can guide interested researchers to delve into community participation factors, governmental and NGO collaborations, and partnerships involving community organizations. Ultimately, the study's insights have the potential to contribute to the sustainable development of rural areas.

The study faced several limitations. Time constraints posed a significant challenge as the primary data collection leading to the unavailability of key informants and necessitating rescheduling. The language barrier hindered communication with rural participants, particularly in understanding the local dialect. Sensitive topics, such as assets and income, yielded inconsistent responses due to respondent discomfort. Additionally respondent bias influenced by surveyors' gender, the potential for biased responses due to surveyor emphasis and respondents' lack of awareness about initiatives collectively contributed to the study's limitations.

Chapter 2: Literature Review

In this chapter, several literatures are reviewed to build up the understanding regarding concepts relevant to rural development, the role of different initiating authorities in rural development and some rural development initiatives in both Bangladesh and global context along with relevant projects.

2.1 Terminologies:

Rural development: Rural development aims to enhance the quality of life and well-being of low-income residents by modifying social and spatial aspects of economic activities. It seeks to create sustainable economic opportunities and empower rural populations, improving access to markets, infrastructure, education, healthcare, and community networks. The ultimate goal is to promote economic growth, self-sufficiency, and better social and economic conditions. Rural development aims to alleviate poverty and enhance rural well-being by not only boosting production and income but also improving essential services like healthcare and education, along with infrastructure development. It encompasses a broad range of activities at various levels, including agricultural productivity enhancement, job creation, healthcare and education improvements, infrastructure

expansion, and housing enhancements, emphasizing a multifaceted approach to rural improvement.

Non-governmental organizations (NGOs): NGOs are global institutions operated by ordinary citizens rather than governments, aiming to address various social, environmental, humanitarian, and development issues. They are formed by individuals, organizations, or communities sharing similar interests to bring about positive change, protect human rights, assist the marginalized, and promote sustainable development. (Haque, 2002)

Community-based organizations (CBOs): Community-based development involves nonprofit, non-governmental, or charity groups serving the community's needs. This approach empowers project beneficiaries to actively participate in planning and execution, ensuring their perspectives, needs, and goals are considered. By involving beneficiaries as co-creators and co-implementers, community ownership and empowerment are promoted, fostering a more inclusive and impactful development process. (Mansuri and Rao, 2004).

2.2 Development Authorities

Rural development is crucial, given the need to address poverty, climate change effects, food security, and urban congestion. Various stakeholders, including the government, NGOs, CBOs, and collaborative efforts, play a role in implementing development initiatives for the country's progress (Islam et al., 2003; The Daily Star, 2020).

2.2.1 Government Organization (GO): Rural development projects are primarily handled by Government. Governments have hierarchical structures, including executive, legislative, and judicial branches. They are organized at different levels (national, regional, local) and follow constitutional frameworks that define their powers and responsibilities. In Bangladesh, the Local Government and Rural Development Board play the major role. The government initiates various programs, but the top-down approach, with urban planners designing initiatives, raises concerns about reaching the impoverished at the grassroots and the efficiency, accountability, and transparency of public fund for these objectives. (Islam et., al., 2003).

2.2.2 Private Organizations (NGO, CBO): NGOs typically have a governing board, an executive director, and specialized programmatic departments. They operate based on their mission and may follow governance guidelines such as the INGO Accountability Charter. NGOs in Bangladesh were

established after the 1970 natural disaster and the 1971 liberation struggle, playing a vital role in "gap filling" by reaching grassroots communities and encouraging decision-making at the field level. They aim to address the needs of rural underprivileged individuals affected by governmental and market failures, ultimately contributing to the creation of social capital. In Bangladesh, the government department responsible for the registration of NGOs is the NGO Affairs Bureau, which operates under the Ministry of Social Welfare. NGOs in Bangladesh are required to register with to legally operate and carry out their activities in the country. Bangladesh currently has 2600 registered NGOs, including well-known organizations like BRAC, ASA, CARE Bangladesh, BURO Bangladesh etc. (Bangladesh National Portal, n.d.).

CBOs often have decentralized structures with elected community leaders. Their framework is community-centric, guided by local needs, addressing issues. Community-based activities allow people to express their true needs and goals since they are deeply ingrained in the society and culture of a place. This allows problems to be accurately characterized and response measures to be created and implemented (Shaw, 2006).

2.2.3 Partnership/ Collaboration: Public-Private Partnership (PPP) is a collaborative arrangement between a government or public sector entity and a private sector organization to leverage the strengths and resources of both sectors to achieve mutually beneficial goals. Problems like lack of co-ordination and transparency, resource constrain etc arise if rural development is initiated by only one individual authority. Projects involving partnerships are therefore necessary to address the shortcomings of the government and NGOs. In Bangladesh, Government-NGO cooperation programs like tuberculosis, leprosy, immunization, and family planning rose in the 1970s and 1980s (Haque, S., 2002).

2.3 Rural Development in Global Context

In the 1970s, Robert McNamara, President of the World Bank, brought rural development to the forefront, emphasizing the plight of the absolute poor in the developing world. He proposed an integrated approach to combat poverty, extending development benefits to marginalized rural groups like small-scale farmers, tenants, and the landless. This strategy aimed to enhance the economic and social well-being of the rural poor.

Majority of rural development projects are found in Asia, Africa, Latin America. Poverty is widespread in many rural areas across these continents, and addressing this issue is crucial for improving the well-being of millions of people. To address these concerns and promote rural development, African governments, international organizations, and NGOs often collaborate on various initiatives aimed at improving infrastructure, healthcare, education, agricultural practices, and economic opportunities in rural areas.

2.3.1 Case study

Govt. Project in Nigeria: The Fadama III Project in Nigeria aims to increase income and improve food security in rural areas by supporting smallholder farmers and agribusinesses. The project provides infrastructure, training, and resources to enhance agricultural productivity and rural development (Ike, P.C., 2012). Governments face challenges in rural development projects, including financial constraints, infrastructure limitations, political instability, land disputes, and community resistance. Addressing these requires strategic planning, community involvement, partnerships, and sustainable practices. (Ngeh, D. B., 2013).

NGO Initiatives in Africa: NGOs in Akwa Ibom State focus on education, food, and empowerment through training. A study with 1250 respondents in rural areas reveals that NGOs play a significant role in improving health, education, and economic opportunities. To enhance their impact, the study suggests improved coordination with the government and greater involvement of rural communities through participatory approaches. (Ocheni, 2015).

In Zimbabwe, NGOs aimed to operate independently and lessen reliance on the government and international agencies, but limited evidence of distinct differences in their activities compared to the government. Creating alternative development options was not a major focus for most NGOs, contrary to the assumption of functioning as parallel forces. (Vivian, J., 1994).

CBO Initiatives in Africa :Small-scale farmers in rural areas of Kenya form cooperatives to collectively purchase agricultural inputs like seeds and fertilizers, access loans, and negotiate better prices for their produce in the market.

In Uganda, women in rural communities establish savings and entrepreneurship groups, such as the Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLAs), to save money, provide small loans to members, and start income-generating activities like small businesses and farming (Barbier,,2019)

2.4 Rural Development in Bangladesh Context

Rural development in Bangladesh has been a crucial focus due to the country's predominantly rural population seeking to address the multifaceted challenges faced by rural populations, including poverty, inadequate infrastructure, and vulnerability to climate-related risks. These initiatives aim to improve the quality of life, economic prospects, and resilience of rural communities, contributing to the country's broader development goals (Haque, 2002).

2.4.1 Policies and Plans:

Rural development in Bangladesh is guided by various policies and plans aimed at addressing the specific challenges faced by rural areas. Here are some key policies and plans related to rural development in Bangladesh:

National Rural Development Policy (NRDP): The NRDP provides a comprehensive framework for rural development in Bangladesh. It emphasizes poverty reduction, infrastructure development, agricultural modernization, and social services delivery in rural areas. The policy encourages the participation of local communities and NGOs in development initiatives.

National Agriculture Policy: This policy focuses on agricultural development in rural areas. It aims to increase agricultural productivity, ensure food security, promote sustainable farming practices, and enhance the livelihoods of farmers, especially smallholders.

National Education Policy: Education is a key component of rural development. This policy aims to enhance the quality of education in rural schools, increase access to education, and reduce the gender gap in education.

National Health Policy: Access to healthcare services is critical in rural areas. This policy emphasizes expanding healthcare infrastructure, training healthcare workers, and improving maternal and child health services in rural communities.

Rural Infrastructure Development: Bangladesh has various plans and programs for rural infrastructure development to enhance connectivity and economic opportunities in rural areas (Islam et. al.,2005)

In the 8th Five-Year Plan (2021-2025), rural development strategies typically include:

- ***Agricultural Modernization:*** Enhancing agricultural productivity through the adoption of modern farming techniques, improved seeds, and better access to credit and agricultural extension services.
- ***Rural Infrastructure Development:*** Investing in rural infrastructure to improve connectivity and access to markets, healthcare, and education.
- ***Promotion of Agribusiness:*** Encouraging agribusiness development, including food processing, value addition, and marketing, to create employment opportunities and increase income for rural populations.
- ***Rural Employment Generation:*** Implementing rural employment programs, such as the Rural Employment and Road Maintenance Program (RERMP), to create temporary employment opportunities for rural laborers and improve local infrastructure simultaneously (8th Five Year Plan, 2020)

2.4.2 Case Study

The Rural Employment and Decent Work Project (REDWP): Launched in 2012 with World Bank and Bangladesh Government funding, this project aimed to combat poverty by creating sustainable employment in rural areas. Implemented in 100 Upazilas from 2009 to 2015, it focused on improving living standards, supporting SMEs, public works, and skill development. Despite challenges, including coordination issues and resource constraints, the project was well-received due to its success in job creation, infrastructure development, training, transparency, and efficient management. (The World Bank, n.d.)

The Mobile Healthcare Unit (MHU): BRAC implemented a community-based healthcare program across 100,000 villages to provide essential healthcare services in remote areas, effectively reducing child mortality by 25% and maternal mortality by 15% since 1999. Mobile health clinics now regularly visit these villages, addressing the previously limited access to healthcare. The project encountered challenges in hard-to-reach areas but ensured community participation in planning, implementation, and monitoring, receiving positive feedback from the communities it serves for meeting their healthcare needs and improving health outcomes (Alam, et al., 2012).

The Rural Infrastructure Services and Employment (RISE) project: Implemented in 2009 across 30 districts with government funding, BRAC's RISE initiative aimed to uplift rural communities

by improving infrastructure and creating employment opportunities. It addressed challenges like inadequate infrastructure, poverty, gender inequality, and environmental degradation. Despite obstacles such as funding shortages, cultural barriers, and natural disasters, the project's strong community involvement ensured ownership and satisfaction among locals, making it a successful and transformative endeavor (Chowdhury, et al., 2004).

Chapter 3: Methodology

Methodology refers to the process or steps by following which a study is accomplished. This process varies with the subject matter and also the context of that particular study. It is a guideline that will lead to the same result mentioned in a study, if followed properly. In a sense, the reliability of a study prominently depends on methodology.

3.1 Selection of Study Area

In this study, rural areas of entire Bangladesh is considered as study area. For sampling 7 upazillas have been selected from 7 districts of Bangladesh through purposive sampling with the concern to evenly cover different parts rather being clustered in certain portion of Bangladesh. Moreover, there was a consideration of surveyor's convenience to reach for data collection. Thus, 7 upazillas under different districts were selected: Ramganj Upazilla (Laxmipur District), Wazirpur Upazilla (Barishal District), Companiganj Upazilla (Noakhali District), Adamdighi Upazilla (Bogura District), Baniachong Upazilla (Habiganj District), Gurudaspur Upazilla (Natore District), Nalitabari Upazilla (Sherpur District).

3.2. Preparation of Coordination Schema, Questionnaire, KII and FGD Question

3.2.1. Coordination Schema Preparation

The Variables have been listed according to the study's objectives for preparing the coordination schema. Each simple variable's level of measurement and source have been listed. It has been attached in appendix-A.

3.2.2. Questionnaire Preparation

For getting data regarding the simple variables, questionnaire survey have been considered. The questionnaire was prepared in a convenient way which was basically structured to ease the data collection considering that the target population was villagers. The questionnaire is attached in appendix-B.

3.2.3 KII and FGD . Question Preparation

Single set of questions have been prepared for KII to interview both village heads and government/NGO offices that could provide an institutional perspective of the initiatives regarding rural development and obtain information about challenges as well as interventions to improve the condition of the specific area. A set of question/topics have been listed for FGD to capture the responses of villagers of different socio-economic group for the purpose of triangulation of data.

3.3. Data Collection

Both primary and secondary data were collected to conduct the study. For primary data collection, a questionnaire survey, FGD, KII was conducted.

3.3.1. Primary Data Collection

3.3.1.1. Questionnaire Survey

A significant part of the data collection was conducted through individual questionnaire survey. In simple random sampling method. Total 290 samples were collected from the survey.

3.3.1.2. Focus Group Discussion (FGD)

To understand the situation better and variation in response, several FGDs have been conducted in different groups of people, the discussions were conducted.

3.3.1.3. Key Information Interview (KII)

In each study area, KII with the village head and several interviews with different government and non-government offices (NGO) have been conducted. The offices provided information about the initiatives that are currently in action for rural development.

3.3.2. Secondary Data Collection

The secondary data have been collected from BBS, Bangladesh National Portal, LGED website (digital map), etc. to get a perception regarding population, demographic data, socio-economic condition of the study areas.

3.4. Data Analysis

3.4.1 Quantitative Analysis

Statistical and mathematical techniques is used to analyze data and identify relationships among variables.

3.4.1.1 Descriptive Analysis

Descriptive analysis is used to present data in a meaningful way through organizing, summarizing, and describing the variables of the dataset such as graphical representations of socio-economic profile (bar chart, pie chart), relationship among the profile with development initiatives and satisfaction (stack column) etc. to provide a clear and concise overview of the data's key features.

3.4.1.2 Statistical Analysis

To check whether the relation/association among variable is statistically significant before graphical representation association test (chi-square test of independence) was conducted. Moreover, Kruskal Walli's H test, Mann-Whitney U Test were also conducted to find significant mean rank difference of community satisfaction among various initiatives.

3.4.2 Qualitative Analysis

To examine non-numerical data, such as key informant interviews, FGD responses and open-ended survey questions thematic analysis technique has been used to understanding and interpreting the underlying meanings, reason and context within qualitative data rather than numerical measurements.

Several themes have been identified based in which the analysis of questionnaire data together with FGD and KII information has been organized in chapter 5 and chapter 6 which are arranged according to objectives of the study stated in chapter 1. A report has been prepared following the

aforementioned methodology to reveal the findings and the analyzed data collected during the survey.

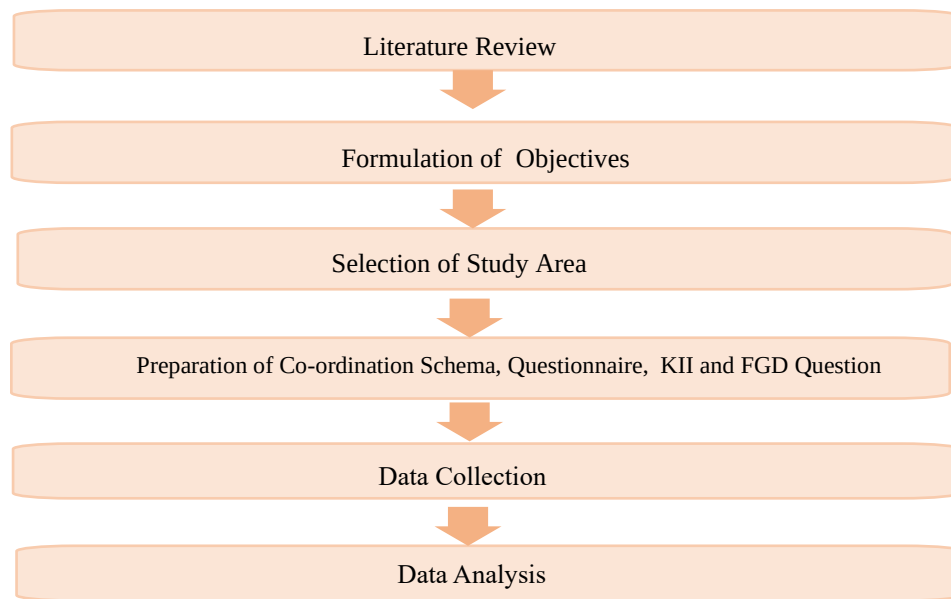
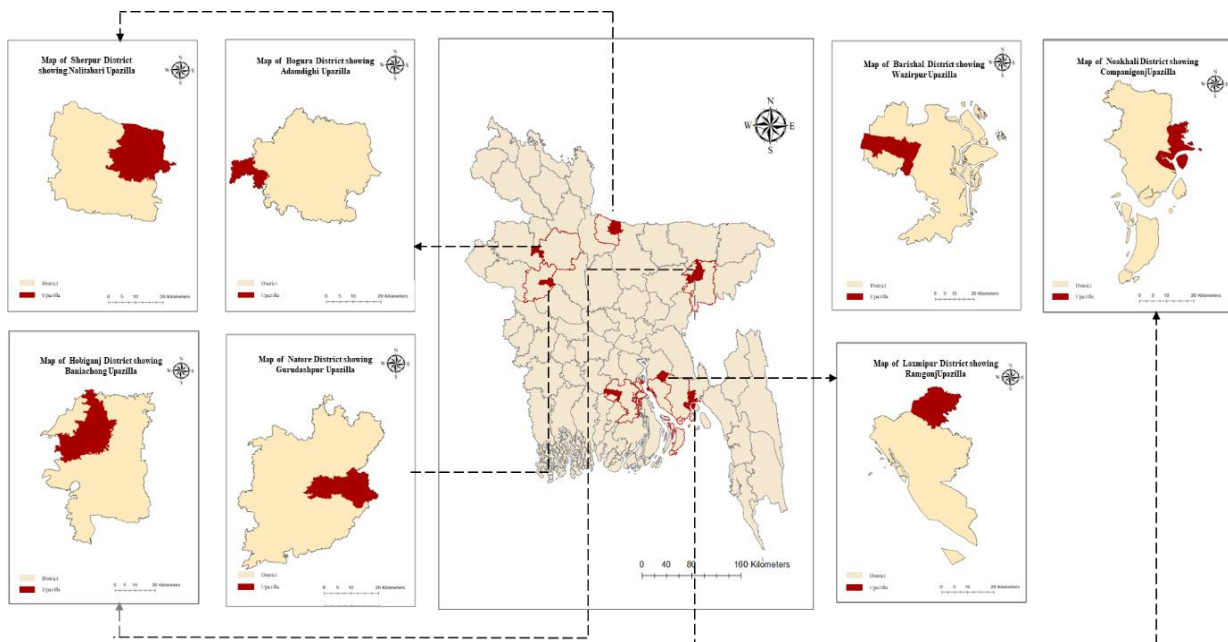


Figure 3.1: Flow diagram of the entire study process

(Source: Author, 2023)

Chapter 4: Study Area Profile

4.1. Location of Study Area



Map 4.1: Maps showing the Districts and Upazilas that have been selected as study areas.
(Source: LGED, 2023)

This study tried to incorporate rural areas of different regions of Bangladesh and explore the development initiatives and perception regarding impact of those initiatives. The districts study areas have been selected to cover almost all regions rather clustering at any part of Bangladesh, and the other smaller administrative units have been chosen according to the convenience of the surveyors. The selected study areas are shown in table-4.1 and Map 4.1. In the Map, the Upazilas are highlighted within the districts.

Table- 4.1: Table showing the selected study areas

District	Upazilla	Total Area (sq km)
Lakshmipur	Ramganj	169.31
Barisal	Wazirpur	249.32
Noakhali	Companiganj	296.60
Bogra	Adamdighi	168.84
Habiganj	Baniachong	482.46
Natore	Gurudaspur	199.40
Sherpur	Nalitabari	327.61

(Source:., 2023)

4.2. Demographic and Socio-economic Profile

Demographic and socio-economic data of study area is collected from both secondary and primary source. Data of secondary sources gives a overview whereas from primary source a detail and clear demographic and socio economic composition can be represented which are in appendix-C.

4.2.1. Gender and Age

The overall gender and age distribution in shown in figure C.1 and C.2 respectively. Each of the study area's some demographic compositions is shown in the following table.

Table- 4.2: Table showing the demographic profile of each study area (Upazilla)

Upazilla	Ramganj	Wazirpur	Companiganj	Adamdighi	Baniachong	Gurudaspur	Nalitabari
Popoutaion	342027	234959	174029	187012	332530	194228	251361
Male Population	80269	116492	89649	94997	163875	91071	124649
Female Population	91025	118467	84380	92015	168655	103157	126712

(Source: National Portal, 2023)

4.2.2 Educational Qualification

Each of the study area's literacy rate compositions is shown in the following table.

Table- 4.3: Table showing the literacy rate of each study area (Upazilla)

Upazilla	Baniachong	Gurudaspur	Ramganj	Nalitabari(2011)	Adamdighi	Companiganj	Wazirpur
Literacy Rate	31.5%	41.8%	57.3%,	39.5%	50.40%	51.31%	62.53%

(Source: National Portal, 2023)

Majority of the people of study area have no formal education and those who have are basically primary education. Small portion go for higher education like graduation and above. The scenario is even worse for women which can be perceived from figure C.3.

4.2.3 Occupation and Income

Occupations like farming, labor, pottery, fishing, livestock, business, govt. or private job, homemaker, student and many other have been observed among the residents of the study areas. The occupation composition of different district found from primary data is shown in figure C.4 of appendix-C. Many households are run by remittance from members particularly in Ramgonj (Laxmipur), Companigonj (Noakhali) and Wazirpur (Barishal) Upazillas. Figure C.5 shows that majority of men are involved in farming whereas women are mostly housewife.

Along with different professions, different income distributions could be seen. The income distribution from each study area is shown in appendix-C, figure C.6.

4.3 Community Facilities and Infrastructure

4.3.1. Existing Condition

The list of community facilities in each study area is attached in appendix-C (table-C.1)

In all the study areas, the construction materials of the houses are soil, tin, brick mostly one-storied. Some specific areas have certain housing pattern like Adamdighi Upazilla earthen house are mostly seen. Condition of infrastructures related to transportation like road, culvert etc vary with different study areas. In Ramgonj Upazilla, there are highest amount of paved roads within the district but the condition is very poor whereas in Gurudashpur Upazilla, the issue is access from agriculture

field rather than the physical condition if road. In Baniachong Upazilla, a hoar area, the road connectivity specifically between urban centers and rural areas are insufficient.

4.3.2. Satisfaction of community regarding facilities

Satisfaction level is measured in 1-5 likert scale where, 1= Very low, 2 = Low, 3 = Moderate, 4 = High, 5 = Very High. For several facilities and services this satisfaction rating is collected and the average value of satisfaction is calculated which is represented in figure 4.1. Here the value 3 indicates moderate satisfaction level below and facilities having average satisfaction value less than 3 are indicated through red and green for facilities having average satisfaction value less than 3. Community is highly satisfied with drinking water facilities and dissatisfied with training related facilities.



Figure 4.1: Bar diagram showing satisfaction level of existing facilities.

Source: Field Survey, 2023

Chapter 5: Rural Development Initiatives

In this chapter is based on first objective of the study that is to explore the rural development initiatives. The chapter is subdivide based on several themes relevant to rural development initiative like frame work of the involved authority, their sectoral contribution, involvement of people, attitude toward collaboration etc. are identified from thematic analysis. Under each theme the analysis of questionnaire data together with FGD and KII information has been organized.

5.1 Involved Authorities

Different authorities are involved in rural development. Primarily government organizations/department like Local Government (Union Parishad), LGED, PWED, Agriculture Office etc. take and execute development initiatives. In support to these NGOs work. Community based development are done through CBO. Moreover, some project are executed through partnership between government and private organizations.

5.1.1 Framework

In the context of development, an institutional framework of authorities refers to the set of organizations, rules, regulations, and structures that guide and govern the functioning of that particular authority. It provides a foundation for how institutions interact, make decisions, allocate resources, and implement policies. From the feedback of government and non-government key informants, FGDs some key components of their institutional framework are given below:

Decision Making: Government decisions within departments and agencies are primarily executed by civil servants and bureaucrats, following established laws, regulations, and procedures in top down approach. On the other hand, NGOs often involve a wide range of stakeholders, including, beneficiaries and community members, in the decision-making process indicating bottom up approach that leads to more diverse perspectives and better-informed decisions. CBOs prioritize active involvement and engagement of community members in decision-making processes to ensures the reflection of needs, priorities, and aspirations of the community.

Funding: Government initiatives are funded through tax revenue, government fund, grant, borrow etc. NGOs get fund from aid and donation. Certain NGOs generate income through fee-based services, selling merchandise, organizing fundraising events or income-generating projects that align with their mission. CBOs often receive financial support from community members.

Evaluation and Monitoring: Government departments and agencies regularly monitor their ongoing activities and programs to ensure they are on track to meet objectives. According to key informant of Ramgonj agriculture office several officers regularly visit field and get feedback from the farmers. NGOs routinely monitor the progress of their projects and programs to assess the effectiveness of their programs and projects gathering data through surveys, interviews. FGD of Ramgonj uphold that CBOs encourage community participation in program evaluation involving community members to share their perspectives, experiences, and insights on the impact of CBO activities.

5.1.2 Sectoral Contribution

Rural areas lagging behind from urban areas in many dimensions. To address those issues rural development need to be in multiple sectors.

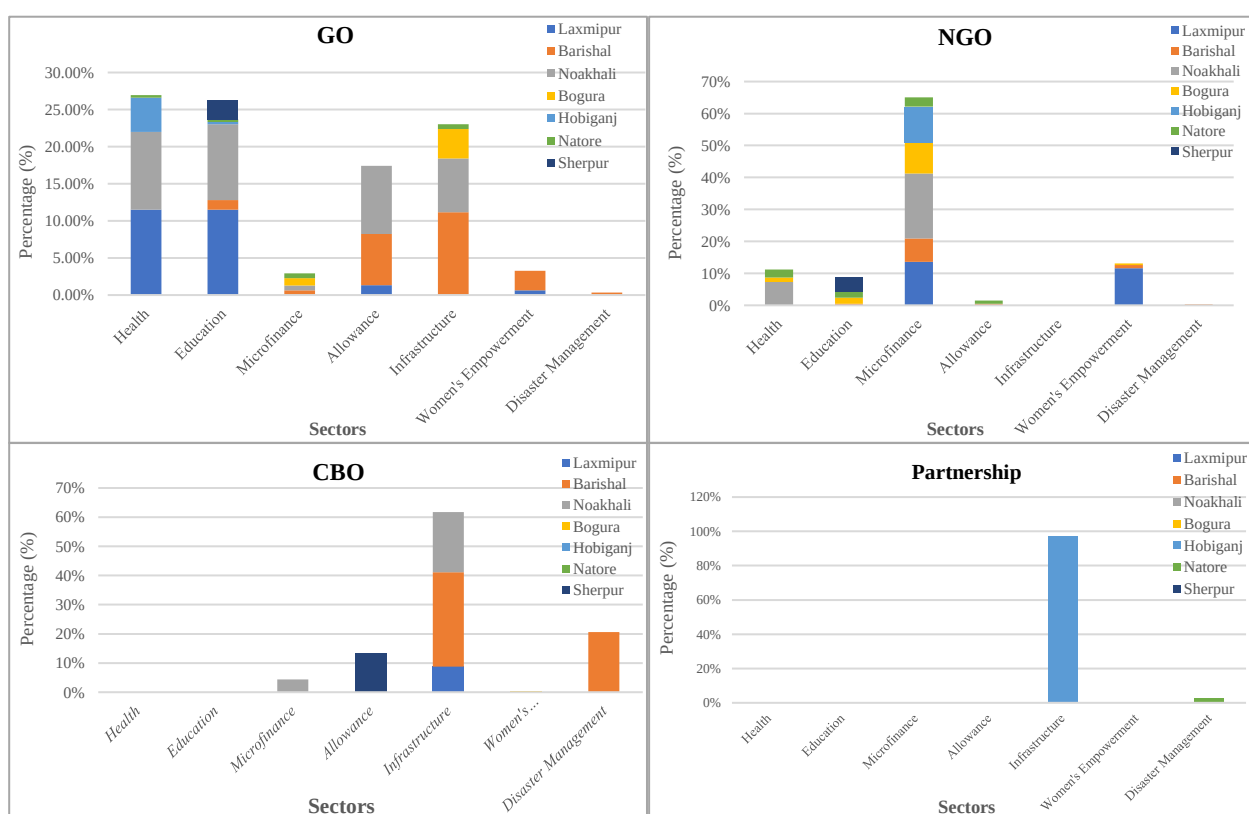


Figure 5.1: Graph showing contribution GO, NGO, CBO and Partnership initiatives in different sectors. Source: Field Survey, 2023

The figure shows that majority of the government initiatives are taken in education and health sectors whereas NGO contribute predominantly in microfinance. CBO initiatives are noticed in

both infrastructure and disaster management sectors. Partnership initiatives are seen to be concentrated in only infrastructure related projects. Infact, this sector has an importance to all type of initiating authority except NGO.

From different FGD it is noticed that most of the rural people are familiar with NGOs through microcredit programs rather than other initiatives. Some key informant of government offices notify that NGOs can not contribute in real development which indicates infrastructural development rather can only do social-well fare as they lack of expertise. CBO initiatives are mostly seen Barishal where FGD indicates that disaster preparedness and resilience work are done through local initiatives. FGD groups of Hobiganj where most of the partnership project take place identified the reason behind partnership project and that is difficulty to reach to the locality as it is a haor area. Infact, the UNO admits that he has not visited the upazilla for a single time. Thus, for implementation of any initiative government need cooperation of local community.

5.1.3 Community Participation

Source of Information: People mostly informed about govt. projects willingly. CBOs and partnership projects marketing done through community meetings like “Uthan Boithak” and others. NGOs do some announcement to spread their messages also through films and clips on public gathering.

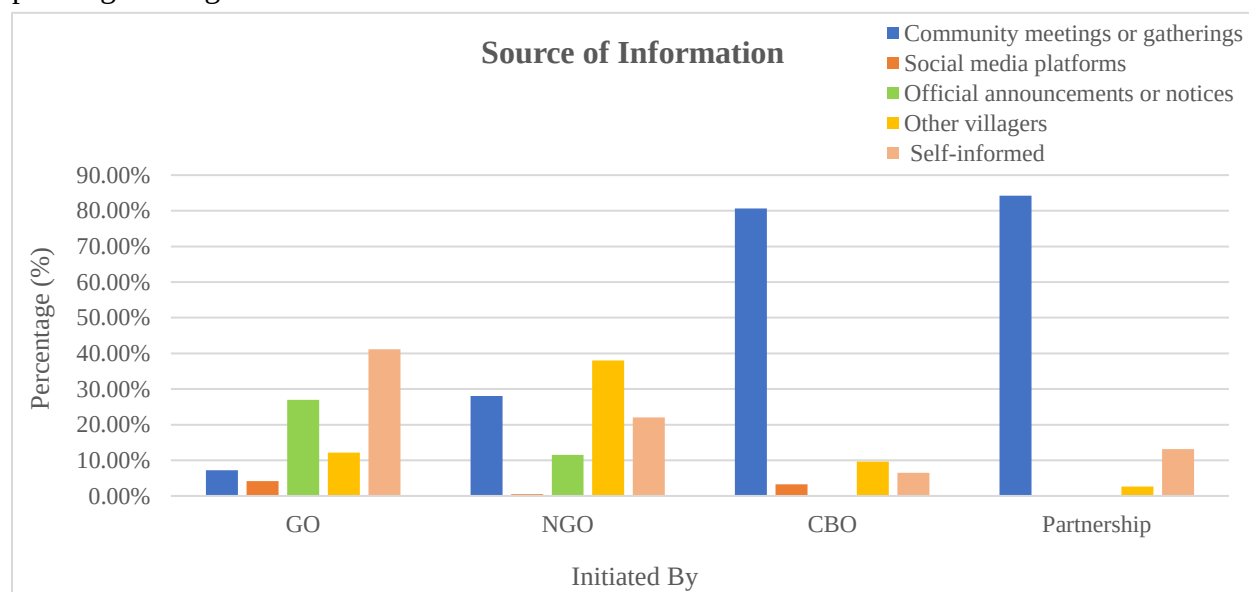


Figure 5.2: Source of Information among initiative authorities

Source: Field Survey, 2023

We found significant association between information source and initiative authorities through Chi-square test of independence ($p\text{-value}=2.2e^{-16}$) and also can see from figure 5.2. Information sharing method of CBOs, and partnership are more effective and inclusive. But GO projects lack of knowing and people have to know about them from personal interest and gain. That rarely ensures inclusiveness.

Involvement of Community: Involvement level varies considering gender (association found through Chi-Square Test of Independence with 90% confidence level, $p\text{-value} = 0.07345 < 0.1$). Figure 5.3 indicates people rarely have decision making opportunities, implementation framework and maintenance work in both GO and NGO initiatives. They only informed about the project. Women are lacking behind in all these sectors where some men with local political or economically strong background have profound voice over these initiatives. FGD confirms the arguments where KII officials denies and claim to have total inclusive approach among all group of people. Also in

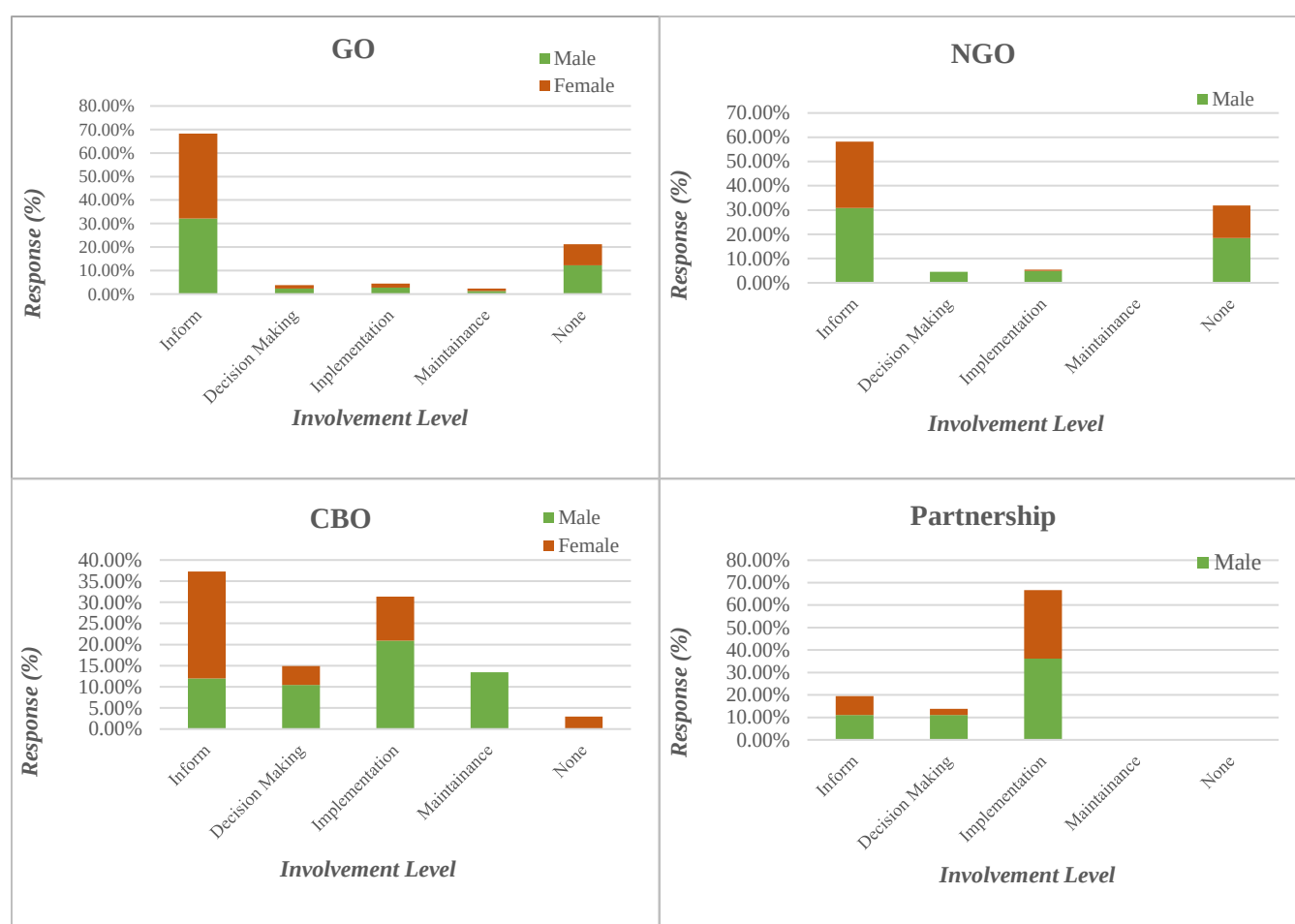


Figure 5.3: Involve level among respondents

Source: Field Survey, 2023

inform level KII officials claim they arrange training sessions and opinion taking seminars. But FGD and questionnaire confirms they rarely have these advantages.

5.1.4 Collaboration

Partnership /collaboration between government and private authority is required for reaching to the local level which only government can not do sometimes as mentioned in the FGD of Hobigonj. This type of collaboration seems to produce better outcome which is reflected in their preference of authority. From the point of view of authorities the attitude towards collaboration greatly varies. Some government key informant consider it necessary in field level execution of initiatives whereas some of them raise the issue of disunity and dominance. Some key informant of NGOs prefer collaboration for the sake of guidance, funding etc. Again some other are unwilling in collaboration indication corruption issues.

Chapter 6: Community Perception Analysis

Chapter focuses on community perception regarding rural development initiatives, covering themes like impact on community, challenges faced by them, preferable authority through thematic analysis of questionnaire, FGD, and KII data.

6.1 Impact on community

Rural development initiatives are taken to address issues like poverty, lack of service and facilities, unemployment, disaster occurrence etc. These initiatives have impact on community in the respective sectors in which these are taken. Sometimes an single sectoral initiative can have impact on diverse aspect of community.

6.1.1 Livelihood and Employment

Livelihood refers to the means and strategies by which people earn a living to support themselves and their families. In rural area livelihood is agriculture based like crop production, cattle rearing, fishing etc together with which non-agricultural activities of business, industry etc. also exist. Employment specifically refers to the act of working in productive activities to earn a wage or salary. It is a subset of livelihood and plays a critical role in ensuring individuals and families have a stable source of income.

Agricultural Activities: Though rural areas are differentiated primarily based on agriculture from urban area. Figure C.5 shows that majority of the male population are engaged in farming. But in the figure 5.1 there no contribution in agriculture sector of the any authority. Infact, the average satisfaction rating for agriculture facilities are below moderate level (figure 4.1).

Most of the KII of agriculture office identifies various initiatives for farmers whereas majority of focus group of farmers complained for not having any kind of help rather surviving on his own effort. In addition, the initiatives are claimed to facilitate some specific group of farmers having connection with officials. But even those specific groups are not fully facilitate as the initiatives are production oriented not including supply concern which is admitted by some key informant of agriculture office.

Non-agricultural Activities: In rural area, non-agricultural activities are associated with local employment opportunities. Due to lack of employment opportunities the overall community satisfaction regarding this sector is low.

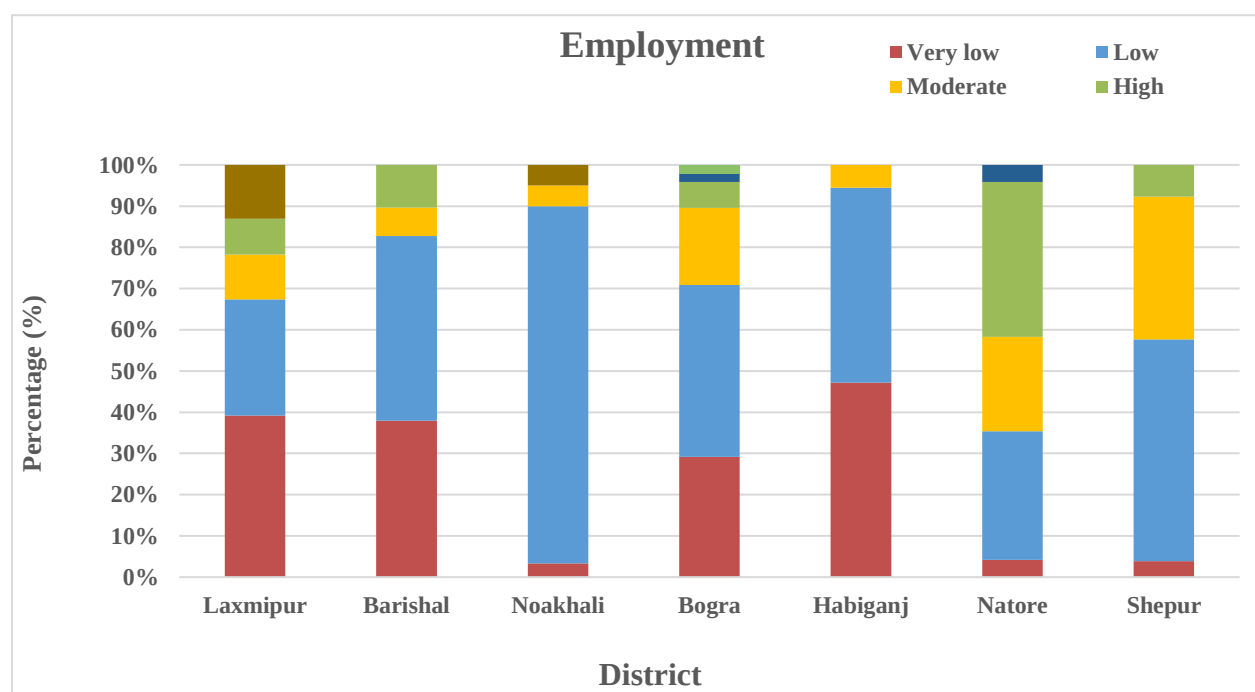


Figure 6.1: Graph showing satisfaction regarding employment in different areas.

Source: Field Survey, 2023

Figure 6.1 shows majority of Noakhali district where remittance contribute in local economy has low satisfaction regarding employment indicating lack local employment opportunity which is

address by the local young people of that area in FGD. Furthermore, training facility to built the capacity of the community is also scarce. In many areas these facilities do not exists (figure 6.2).

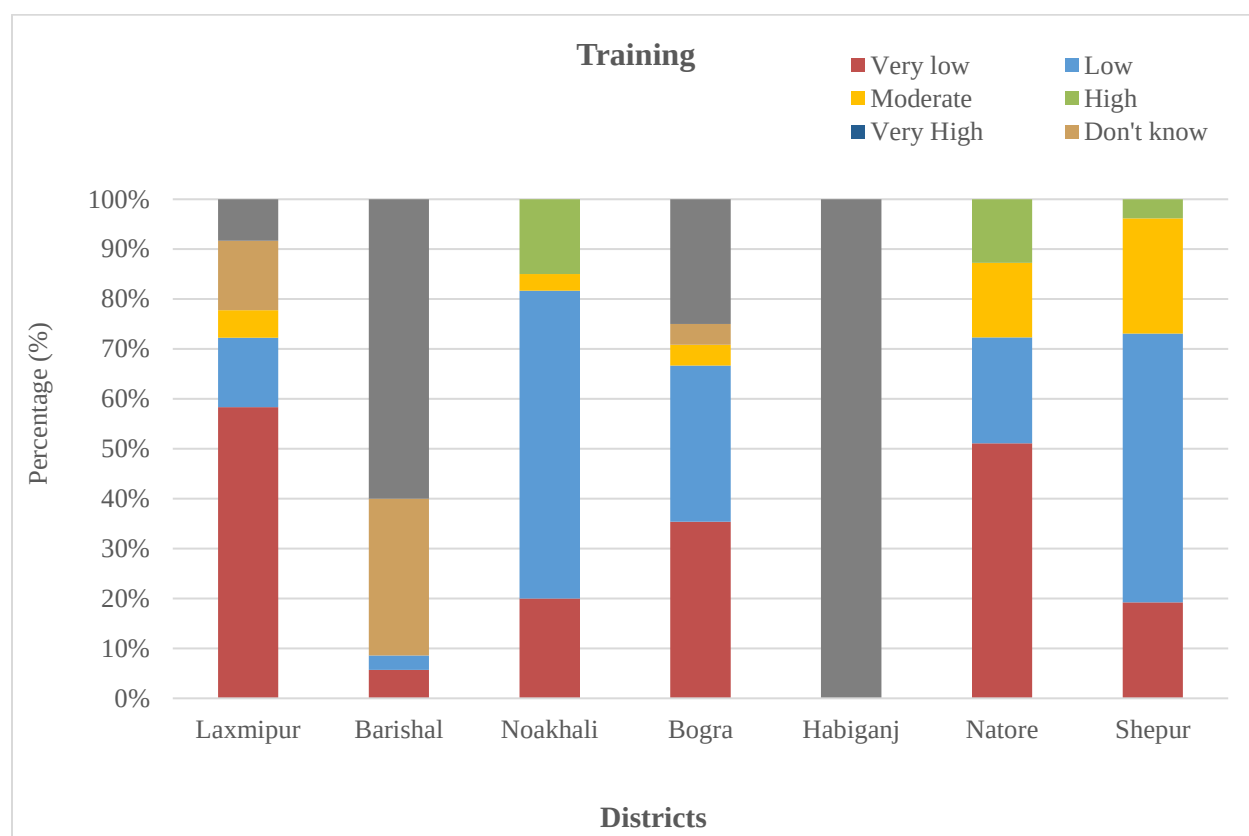


Figure 6.2: Graph showing satisfaction regarding training facilities in different areas.

Source: Field Survey, 2023

6.1.2 Basic Facilities and Infrastructure

Health: Poor Health facility is noticeable in all rural areas. Mostly lack of accessibility is a major problem. From the questionnaire, people's satisfaction with health facilities lies under a moderate level (figure 4.1). NGOs and the government mostly work for the health sector. From figure 6.3 though the government has a large investment in the health sector, people are mostly satisfied with NGOs. Mann Whitney U test proves that satisfaction levels in a health facility are largely different with initiative type at 99% confidence level. Lack of accessibility is the main cause of private dominance in the health sector. From FGD, the majority of people claimed that public health facilities are at long distances and provide only basic treatment. Pregnant women and critical patients are forced to go to city or private health care for quality treatment. People do not get any door-to-door health care from govt whereas the private sector sometimes visits them to provide

basic health knowledge and care though it is also very rare. From KII, government authorities claimed their broad health initiatives and successful outcomes with people participation. NGOs

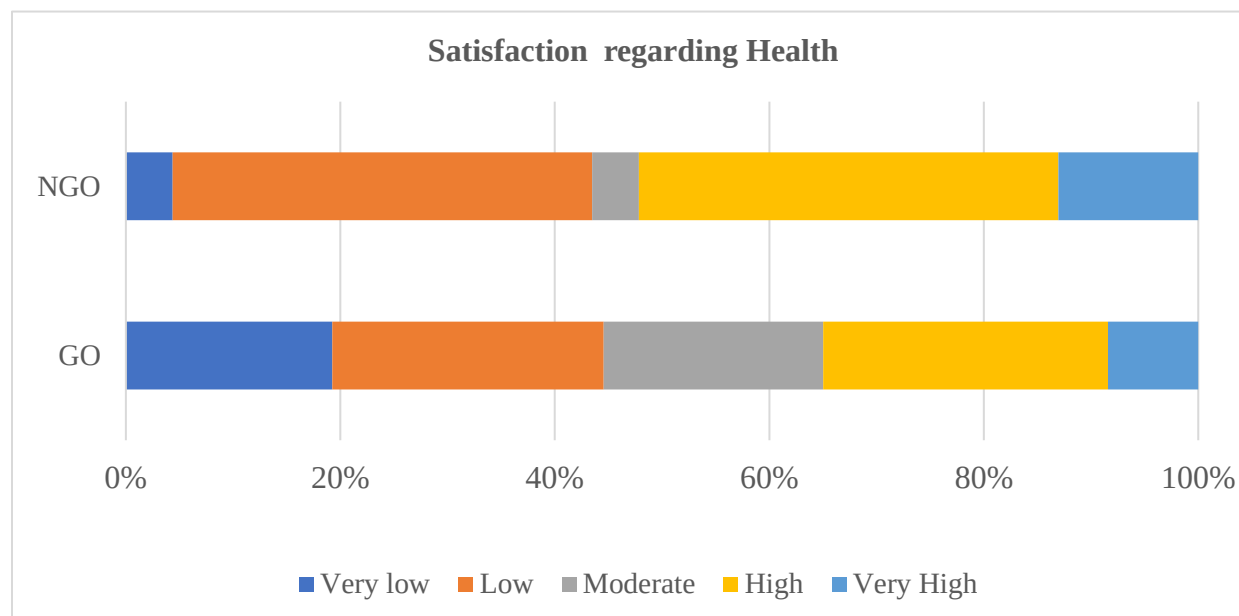


Figure 6.3: Graph showing satisfaction regarding health initiatives of GO, NGO.

Source: Field Survey, 2023

like BRAC work for TB, HIV etc. But mostly vaccination is a priority.

Education: Satisfaction for the education sector is above a moderate level. (figure 4.1) Mostly govt and NGOs work for education facilities. From the Mann-Whitney U test, no significant difference in satisfaction found with initiative type. Number of schools and colleges are sufficient in rural areas. People mostly want to avail only secondary education. For lack of interest in higher studies, people mainly prefer to migrate. Many government authorities claim that they encourage people for higher education but it is difficult to bring significant differences in the short term.

Infrastructure: Most of the infrastructure projects are of road construction to facilitate transportation. But the satisfaction level in this sector is below moderate level.

From FGD, there are a lot of pucca roads but most of them are in poor condition. Villagers suffer from daily commutes. From KII, govt has a large budget for construction but less attention to maintenance. As a result, pucca roads are present but people cannot move comfortably due to poor condition. Some FGD raise the issue of direct access from agriculture field to local market through road that lower the satisfaction level.

Disaster Shelter: CBOs drive disaster projects in specific disaster-prone areas, while government authorities claim superior disaster preparedness with minimal community participation. This disconnect can impact the effectiveness of disaster management efforts leading toward low level of satisfaction regarding these facilities shown in figure 4.1.

Water Shortages and Salinity Issues: Although overall water satisfaction is generally high according to the survey response, focus group discussions (FGDs) reveal recurring water shortages, particularly during specific months in the Hobiganj haor area. Additionally, salinity issues in Barishal affect water quality and availability.

6.1.3 Empowerment

Women are in poor condition in rural areas with respect to urban areas. Main reasons are education and occupation opportunity. From questionnaire survey (figure 6.4) we see, women are mostly homemakers with no formal education. Government and NGOs have been working for women's empowerment. CBO and partnership projects have not emphasized the sector much but they include women in the decision-making and implementation level which is absent in NGO and GO projects. However, women respondents are more satisfied with NGO initiatives than GO initiatives significantly proven through the Mann-Whitney U test , $p\text{-value} = 0.054 < 0.1$).

From FGD, social aspects and cultural conservation are the main obstacles in their way of empowerment. Male still dominates their decision, dowry systems in the name of help, decline to let their job etc. But in some areas like Barisal, women personally said that they do not want to avail formal education and do a job. In contrast, lack of job opportunities are hampering women's desire for a job in other areas. Underlying reason of being more satisfied with NGO is microcredit projects that mostly deals with women which they consider a step of empowerment.

Women welfare authorities and NGOs have taken many initiatives for women employment. In Laxmipur, no woman employees are present in the women's welfare office. As women are mostly illiterate and male dominate their decisions, initiatives cannot improve the situation much. Women are mostly satisfied with the microfinance system. Though women get priority in the loan system, they do not use it for their own development.

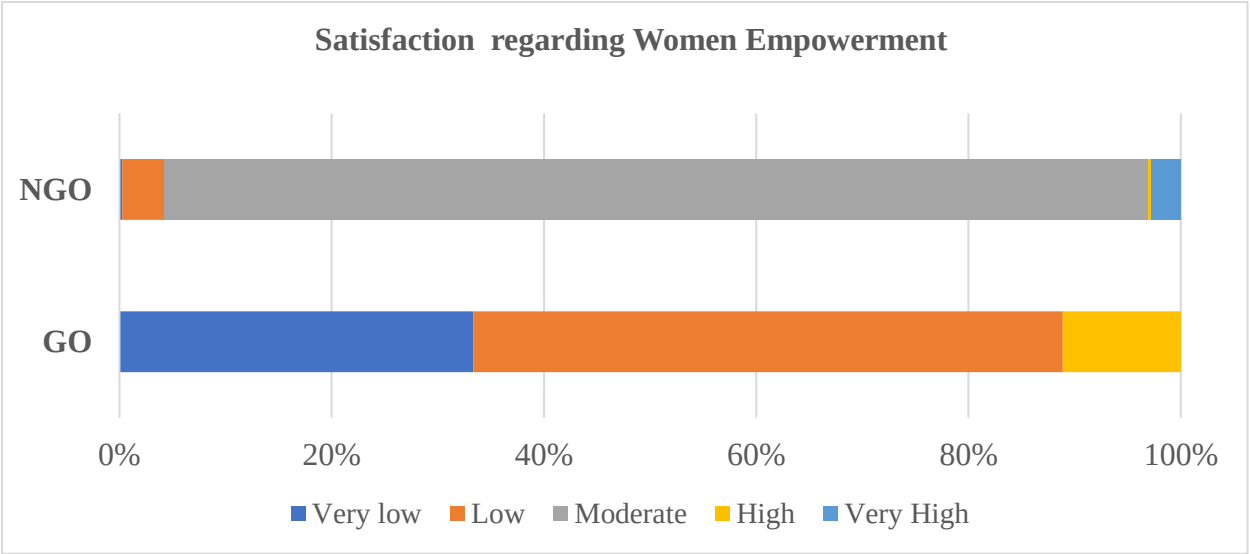


Figure 6.4: Graph showing satisfaction of women regarding women empowerment initiatives of GO and NGO. Source: Field Survey, 2023

6.2 Challenge and Inconvenience

In many areas, challenges arise from corruption and project delays, with government officials attributing delays to a manpower shortage. NGOs face funding issues, although officials in one

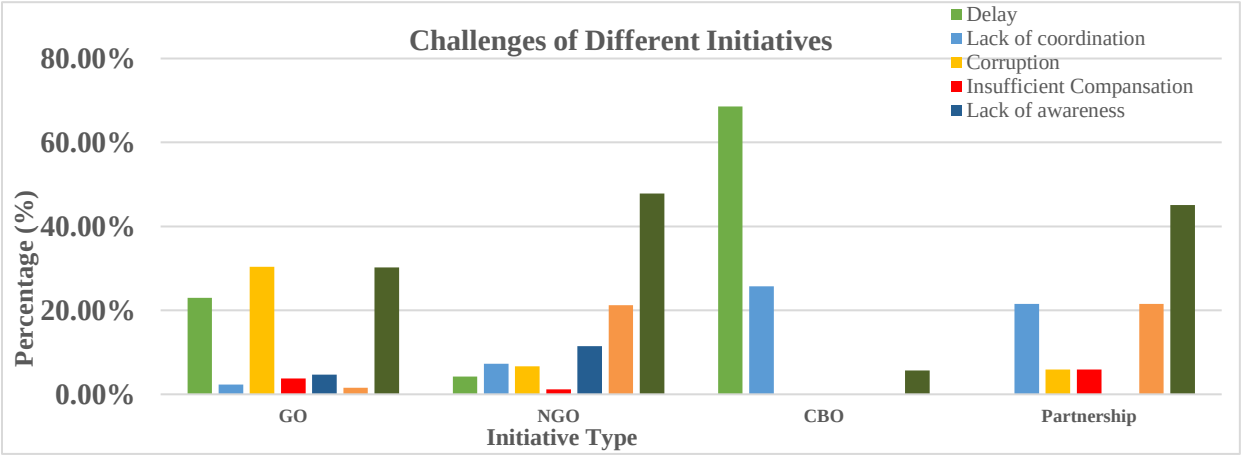


Figure 6.5: Challenges of GO, NGO, CBO and Partnership Projects faced by community. Source: Field Survey, 2023

region claim to have sufficient funding and seek new clients. Partnership projects generally encounter fewer challenges, with increased manpower and improved accessibility being notable advantages (figure 6.5). However, in a specific area (KII), opinions on partnerships vary, with some favoring them for enhanced manpower and ease of reaching people, while others maintain skepticism due to perceived government corruption, highlighting differing perspectives. Additionally, CBO projects encounter coordination problems among participants, further illustrating the multifaceted nature of development challenges in the region. Chi square test proves that there is significant association ($p\text{-value} = 2.2e-16$) between challenges and initiative type.

Authorities also face many problems implementing initiatives. Such as being muslim family, many people are not interested in taking loan though they have enough funding, social aspects, and culture hindrances for woman's empowerment, illiteracy, and being harassed in case of failure to pay debt. Moreover, political biases, stakeholders, etc also obstruct the initiatives.

6.3 Authority Preference

Considering these challenges, people offers their preferable authorities (figure 6.6). Though people are not quite satisfied with the GO initiatives, they offered that the most. People think government will work al least somewhat in favour of people from their responsibility and political manifesto. They fear NGOs or other authority will worsen the condition. One member from FDG told, “NGOs only do microfinance and then come to collect interest, they will not work in favour of us...”. Also KII official from Women Welfare in Laxmipur said, ”Some work will be done if funds goes in hand of government authority though there is challenge of corruption, NGOs will do nothing...”.

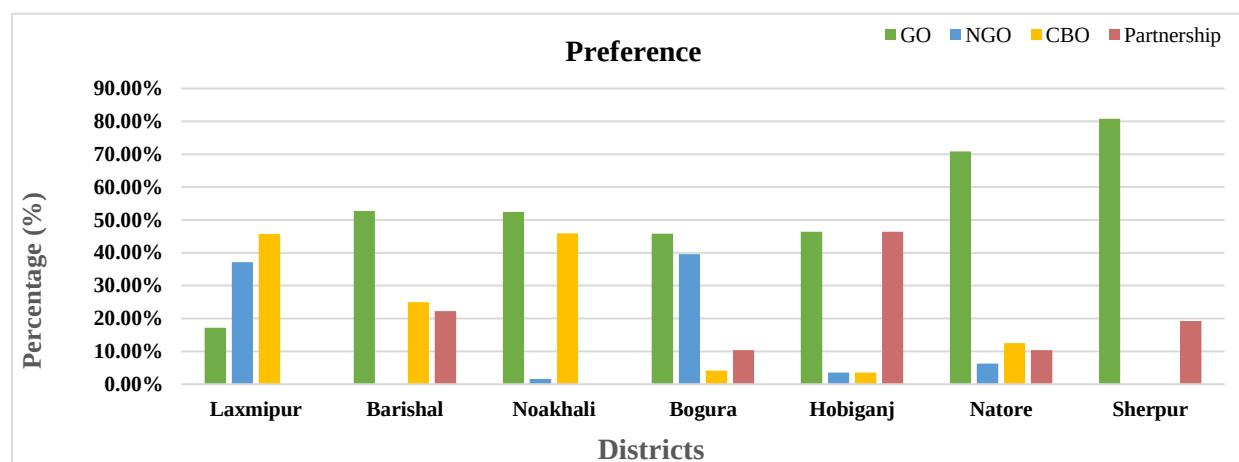


Figure 6.6: Preferable authority in different distritcs

Source: Field Survey, 2023

Chapter 7: Major Findings and Recommendation

The study aims to explore the rural development initiatives of Bangladesh and community perception regarding the impact of those initiatives. Based on these objectives primary data collected from questionnaire, FGD, KII are analyzed and come up with some findings which are described in this chapter together with recommendation.

7.1 Major Findings

- **Lack of Agricultural Initiatives:** There is a notable absence of significant agricultural development initiatives though Bangladesh is one of the most favourable place for agriculture activity, which hampers the growth of the agricultural sector in the region. This lack of support affects farmers' productivity and income.
- **Insufficient Local Employment and Training Opportunities:** The region suffers from a shortage of local employment opportunities and training programs. This limits the prospects for skill development and livelihood improvement for residents in their communities which push them to migrate in cities and abroad for their livelihood.
- **Government Health Projects Struggle to Provide Services:** Though there are many projects by the government, government-led healthcare projects face challenges in delivering adequate services, leading to the dominance of the private healthcare sector. This disparity in access to healthcare services can impact the overall health of the population and push the villagers to private healthcare which cost high significantly.
- **Construction-Oriented Investment in Infrastructure:** There is a predominant focus on constructing new infrastructure, but insufficient attention is paid to maintenance. Neglecting maintenance can lead to infrastructure degradation over time.
- **Location Specific Need:** Development requirement is not same for all location. Some location may have advantageous condition regarding a facility whereas other may require initiatives for improvement of that facility.
- **Partnership Challenges:** While there are positive responses in partnership-driven areas, government agencies and non-governmental organizations (NGOs) may hesitate to collaborate effectively. This can lead to missed opportunities for joint initiatives and community development.

These findings collectively highlight key challenges and areas of concern within the region, emphasizing the need for targeted interventions and policy improvements to address these issues comprehensively.

7.2 Policy Recommendation

7.2.1 Community based Recommendation

From the analysis of the community response several recommendation on different aspects is represented in table 7.1.

Table 7.1: Recommendation of community in percentage

Recommendation	Percentage (%)
Transportation	26%
Health	24%
Education	2%
Employment	14%
Agriculture (Farming equipment)	8%
Training	8%
Electricity	3%
Allowance	2%
Others	13%

Source: Field Survey, 2023

7.2.2 Findings based Recommendation

1. ***Agriculture-based Development and Rural Employment Generation:*** Establishment of agriculture-based industries addressing the issue of supply and employment generation. Program of incentives, training, and credit access facilitating local businesses.
2. ***Enhancement of Rural Healthcare Facilities:*** Ensure the availability and accessibility of quality healthcare facilities in rural areas. This includes adequate staffing, well-equipped health centers, and the promotion of health awareness programs. Accessible healthcare is essential for improving the overall well-being of the rural population.

3. ***Women Prioritization:*** Prioritize the empowerment of rural women through education and skills training initiatives. These programs should aim to transform social conditions by providing women with opportunities for economic independence, leadership roles, and active participation in decision-making processes. Also opportunity of agriculture through crop diagnosis and other activity that values the economy and also can be done from home.
4. ***Even Distribution of Infrastructure Investment:*** Allocate infrastructure investment resources evenly between construction and maintenance. While building new infrastructure is essential, neglecting the maintenance of existing facilities can lead to inefficiencies and reduced infrastructure lifespan. A balanced approach ensures the longevity and effectiveness of infrastructure projects.
5. ***Locational need Assurance Framework:*** Develop a locational need assurance framework that prioritizes local-level needs within a comprehensive planning strategy. This approach ensures that development initiatives are tailored to the specific requirements and challenges of each locality, leading to more targeted and impactful interventions.
6. ***Promoting Partnership:*** Encourage collaboration and partnerships among government agencies, NGOs, and community-based organizations (CBOs). Effective partnerships can leverage collective resources, expertise, and networks to address multifaceted development challenges. Building strong collaborative networks will enhance the efficiency and reach of development initiatives.

Chapter 8: Conclusion

Rural development in Bangladesh is of paramount importance, serving not only to uplift impoverished rural communities but also to stimulate economic growth and enhance overall societal well-being. The collaborative efforts of the government, NGOs, and community-based development initiatives working in partnership have become indispensable in addressing the unique challenges faced by rural areas, ultimately fostering sustainable change and improving the living conditions of millions of rural people. Numerous studies have explored these initiatives and sought to gauge the community's perception of their impact. This study has provided a

comprehensive overview of rural development efforts in Bangladesh, highlighting their critical role in achieving lasting national prosperity while shedding light on the persistent challenges faced by rural communities. The major findings of this research emphasize the pressing need for initiatives to prioritize areas such as agriculture, women's empowerment, and microfinance, with a particular focus on addressing the needs of the hardcore poor. Another significant overview ventured into a detailed examination of the initiatives undertaken by the government, NGOs, and local communities for rural development in Bangladesh, concurrently investigating how these efforts are perceived by the community. This study's broad scope allowed for a deep dive into development patterns and the influencing factors in rural areas, all of which are shaped by government policies, non-governmental organizations, and grassroots initiatives. By concentrating their efforts on comprehensive rural development strategies, these stakeholders have the potential to continue playing a pivotal role in shaping a more prosperous and equitable future for the nation. The insights gleaned from this research offer invaluable guidance for more informed policy-making including public recommendations and the formulation of future development strategies.

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Appendix A

Questionnaire:



**Department of Urban and Regional Planning
Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology**

Ques. No.

“A STUDY ON THE GOVERNMENT, NGO AND CBO INITIATIVES FOR RURAL DEVELOPMENT”

Name of the village:

Location of the village:

Assalamualaikum/Adab. We are the Level-3, Term-2 students of the Department of Urban and Regional Planning, Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET). We are conducting research titled ‘A Study on the Government, NGO and CBO Initiatives for Rural Development’. To fulfill the objectives of our research we need information on initiatives taken and planned on particular villages and people’s perception on the initiatives. This research is designed solely for academic purpose and all your responses will remain confidential. We shall be extremely grateful if you agree to cooperate with us and give some of your time to answer a set of questions that we have presented below. We thank you in advance for your kind cooperation. For further query, please contact Dr. Neelopal Adri, Assistant Professor, Department of Urban and Regional Planning (URP), Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET), Dhaka-1000. on this number: +8801768381670

1. Socio-Economic Information of the Respondent:

1.1 Gender	1.2 Age	1.3 Education	1.4 Occupation	1.5 Monthly Family Income (Tk)	1.6 Specially Abled	1.7 Membership
1. Male 2. Female 3. Others	1. Below 18 2. 18-29 3. 30-39 4. 40-49 5. 50-59 6. 60 and above	1. No formal education 2. Primary 3. Junior Secondary 4. Secondary 5. Higher Secondary 6. Graduate 7. Post grad and above	1. Farming 2. Labour 3. Pottery 4. Fishing 5. Livestock rearing 6. Business 7. Govt. or private job 8. Homemaker 9. Student 10. Others -----	1. 0 – 5,000 2. 5,001 – 10,000 3. 10,001 – 15,000 4. 15,001 – 20,000 5. 20,001 – 30,000 6. 30,001 – 50,000 7. Above 50,000	1. Yes (Please specify) 2. No	1. GO 2. NGO 3. CBO 4. None

2. Evaluation of Existing Condition in Rural Areas:

Please rate your satisfaction level of the following services of the village from 1 to 5. Here, **5 indicates the very satisfactory** and **1 indicates the very dissatisfactory condition**. Put a tick in the 'N/A' field if a facility is not available in the village.

	1	2	3	4	5	Don't Know	N/A
2.1 Transport network (road, bridge, culvert)							
2.2 Microfinance system							
2.3 Health facilities							
2.4 Sanitation							
2.5 Employment generation							
2.6 Women empowerment							
2.7 Drinking water							
2.8 Access to education							
2.9 Housing shelter and disaster management							
2.10 Modern agriculture							
2.11 Electricity and energy supply (solar, biogas energy)							
2.12 ICT and internet provision							
2.13 Training centers							
2.14 Community participation							
2.15 Growth center and local market							
2.16 Others-----							

Questionnaire:

[illegible]

Questionnaire

- Sector :** 1. Health 2. Education 3. Poverty Reduction 4. Employment Generation
5. Infrastructure 6. Women's Empowerment 7. Disaster Management 8. Others (specify...)
- Initiated by:** 1. GO 2. NGO 3. CBO 4. Partnership
- Awareness:** 1. Aware 2. Moderately aware 3. Unaware
- Information source:** 1. Community meetings or gatherings 2. Social media platforms
3. Official announcements or notices 4. Other villagers 5. Others.....
- Involvement level:** 1. Inform 2. Decision Making 3. Implementation 4. Maintenance 5. None
- Impact:** 1. Positive 2. Negative 3. Both 4. None
- Challenges:** 1. Delay 2. Lack of coordination 3. Corruption 4. Insufficient compensation
5. Lack of awareness and participation 6. Others.....
- Condition:** 1. Better 2. Worse 3. Same as before 4. Don't know 5. Not applicable

4. Overview on Development Programs:

4.1 Do the program outcomes match with your expectations?

1. Yes 2. No (Please specify the reason).....
.....

4.2 Rank the authorities below in terms of your preference and trustworthiness:

Authority	GO	NGO	CBO	Partnership
Rank				

4.3 What improvements would you like to see in the future rural development initiatives by GO, NGOs, and community-based organizations?

.....
.....

Name of the Interviewer:
Date:
Duration of the interview:

Signature:
Time:
Phone No. of Interviewee:

Thank You for Your Kind Co-operation

FGD Question:

- Groups:**
1. Women
 2. Young (Unemployed)
 3. Old
 4. Parents
 5. Farmer
 6. Not involved/ not benefitted by any initiatives

Topic	Group
• Preferable approach and sector of rural development • Before after scenario/ Improvement • Source of information regarding initiatives	All
○ Besides being housewife, are you involved in any extra economic activities? ○ If yes, earlier or after initiatives? ○ Family planning / maternal welfare related initiatives? ○ Deposit schemes/ microcredit/ saving/ group initiative (CBO) ○ Any initiatives regarding early marriage/ dowry ○ Woman education?	Woman
○ Any earlier job /work experiences? ○ If yes, Reason behind fired/leaving? ○ Searching for jobs now? ○ If no, why? ○ Any initiatives favorable for them? (Training, microcredit,) ○ Any deprivation/ lack of opportunity (reach, illegibility, incompatibility)	Young
○ How do you spend your day? ○ Involvement in any initiative or group for development (CBO) ○ Share of experiences regarding village	Old
○ Generational / self-encourage. ○ Challenges ○ Any adaptation in farming (land, technical, fertilizer, crop / seed type) ○ Alt occupation (lean season, better livelihood) ○ Any facility (credit, subsidy, irrigation) and from whom ○ Opinion (fair price, middleman)	Farmer

KII Question



Department of Urban and Regional Planning
Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology

Name:

Office: ...

Designation:

Key Informant Interview (KII) on
“A Study on The Government, NGO and CBO Initiatives for Rural Development”

2. In general, in which sectors the initiatives are taken? Is there any prioritized sector?
3. Is there any sector which seems to be lagging behind in terms of both private and public initiatives?
If yes, is there any plan for improvement in that sector?
4. How often you do field visit and arrange training session?
5. How do you ensure that your initiatives reach the target group members?
6. Is financial aid available and accessible to everyone, like poor farmers, small entrepreneur, and woman?
7. How do you evaluate your project outcomes? What are the parameters and driving factors?
8. Do you implement any collaboration projects? If no, mention the reason. If yes, what are the advantages/
disadvantages in terms of individual projects?
9. How does the project adapt to changes in the local context or challenges during implementation?
10. Do you think private projects are parallel or complementary or contradictory with govt. projects?
11. What are the financing sources?
12. What are the challenges you face while implementing the projects?
13. What are the extents of initiatives? (eg. working area)
14. Are there specific goals for different sectors?
15. If there is any incomplete project, mention reason. (on going/ lack of resources/ other inconveniences)
16. Can you share any successful case study/project with a significant positive impact on the rural community?
17. What are the key lessons learned from your experience working on this rural development project?
18. In your opinion, what are the critical factors that contribute to the success of a rural development project?

Appendix B

Co-ordination Schema

Objective	Variable			Level of Measurements	Source
1. To explore the Government organization, NGO, and Community initiatives for rural development in Bangladesh.	Available initiating authorities			Nominal	Primary
	<u>Sector</u> - Health - Education - Poverty - Employment Generation - Infrastructure Development - Women Empowerment - Disaster Management - Others (specify...)				
	Scale				
	Goals				
	Target Group			Nominal and Ordinal	
	<u>Age</u> - Child - Young - Middle Aged - Old - All	<u>Gender</u> - Male - Female - Both	<u>Special Case</u> - Differently able - Disaster victim - Others		
	Major Action				
	Challenges faced by authority			Nominal	
	Outcome				
	Collaboration Project (if any)				

Objective	Variable	Level of Measurements	Source
2. To investigate the community's perception regarding the impacts of the initiatives.	Age	Interval	Primary
	Gender	Nominal	
	Education	Ordinal	
	Occupation	Nominal	
	Household Income	Ordinal	
	<u>Awareness</u> - Yes - No	Nominal	
	Impact		
	<u>Involvement/Participation</u> - Yes - No If yes, then in which level - Inform - Decision Making - Implementation - Maintenance		
	Challenges faced by community		
	<u>Satisfaction level</u> i. Yes ii. No iii. Don't know		
	<u>Preferred initiative</u> i. Government iii. Community ii. NGO iv. Partnership		
	Recommendation		

Appendix C

Demographic and Socio-economic data of study area

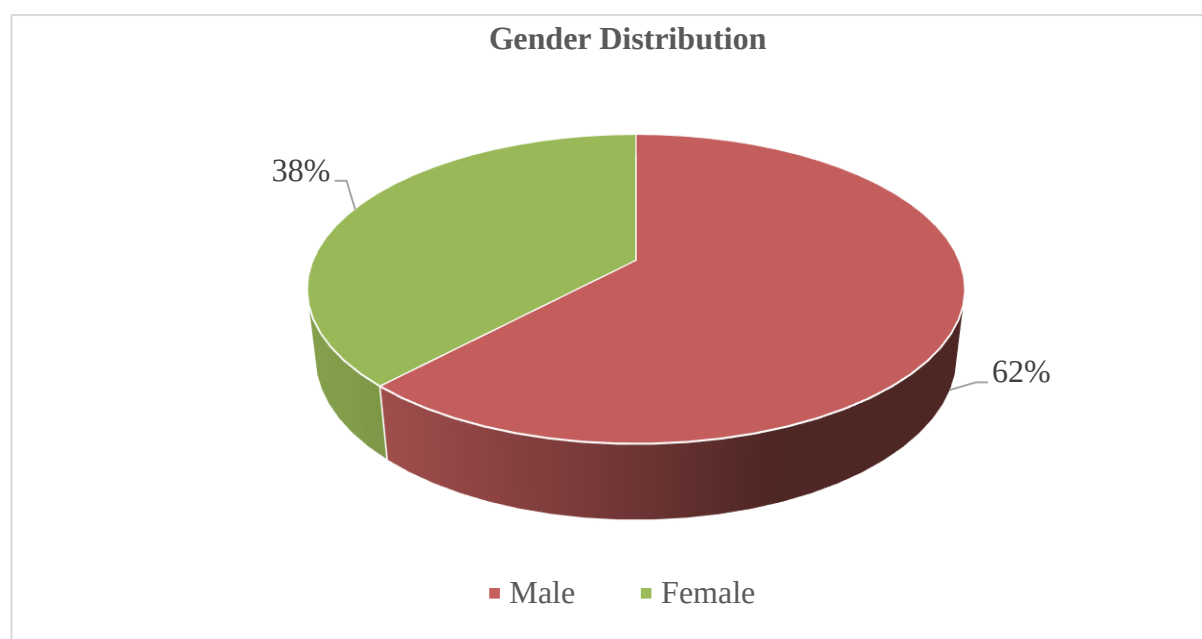


Figure C.1: Graph showing gender distribution of study area.

Source: Field Survey,2023

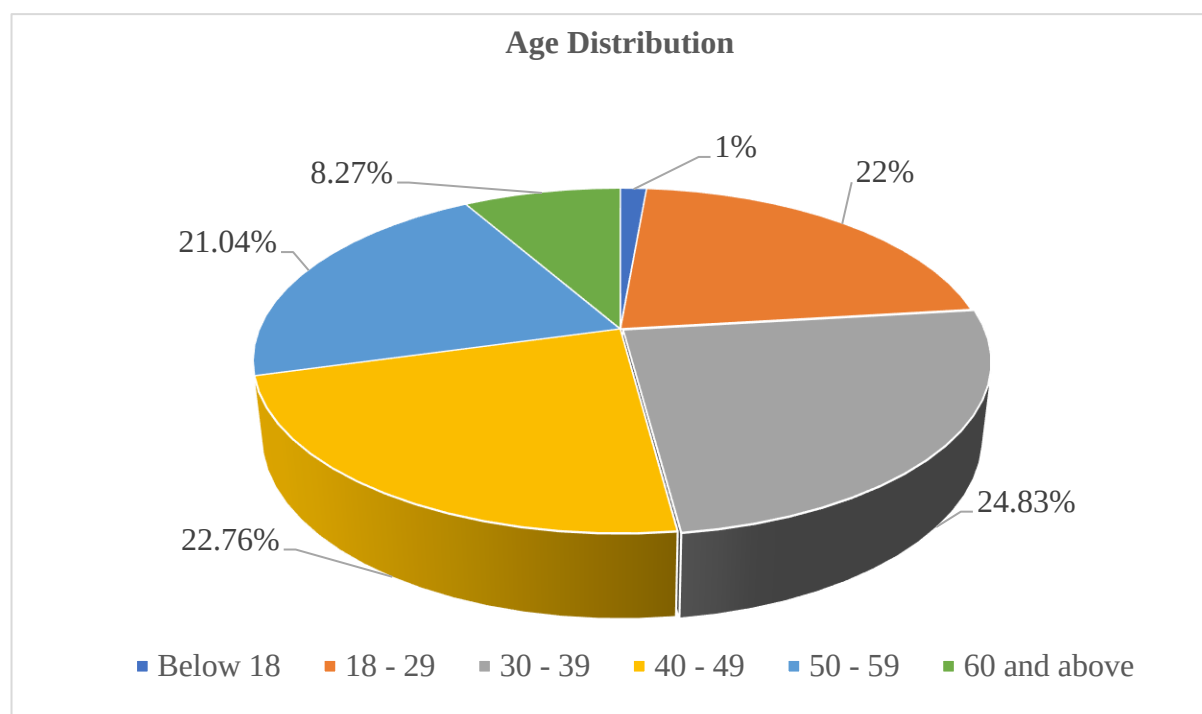


Figure C.2: Graph showing age distribution of study area.

Source: Field Survey,2023

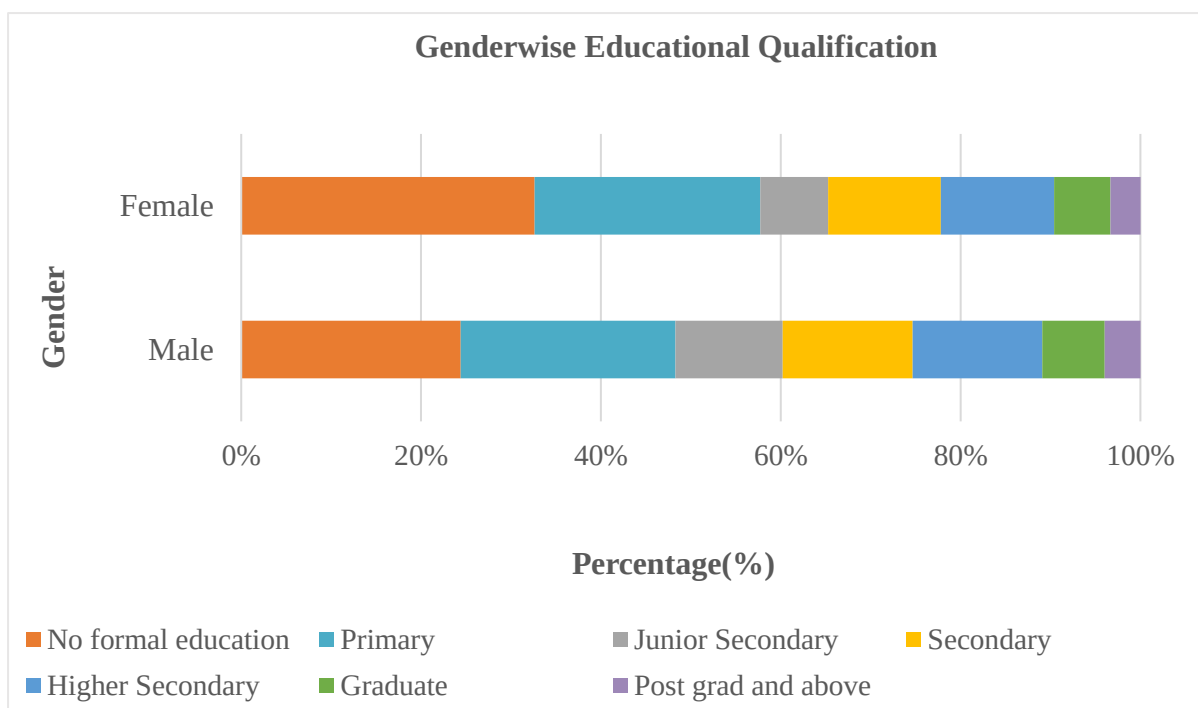


Figure C.3: Graph showing overall and gender wise educational qualification of respondent
Source: Field Survey,2023

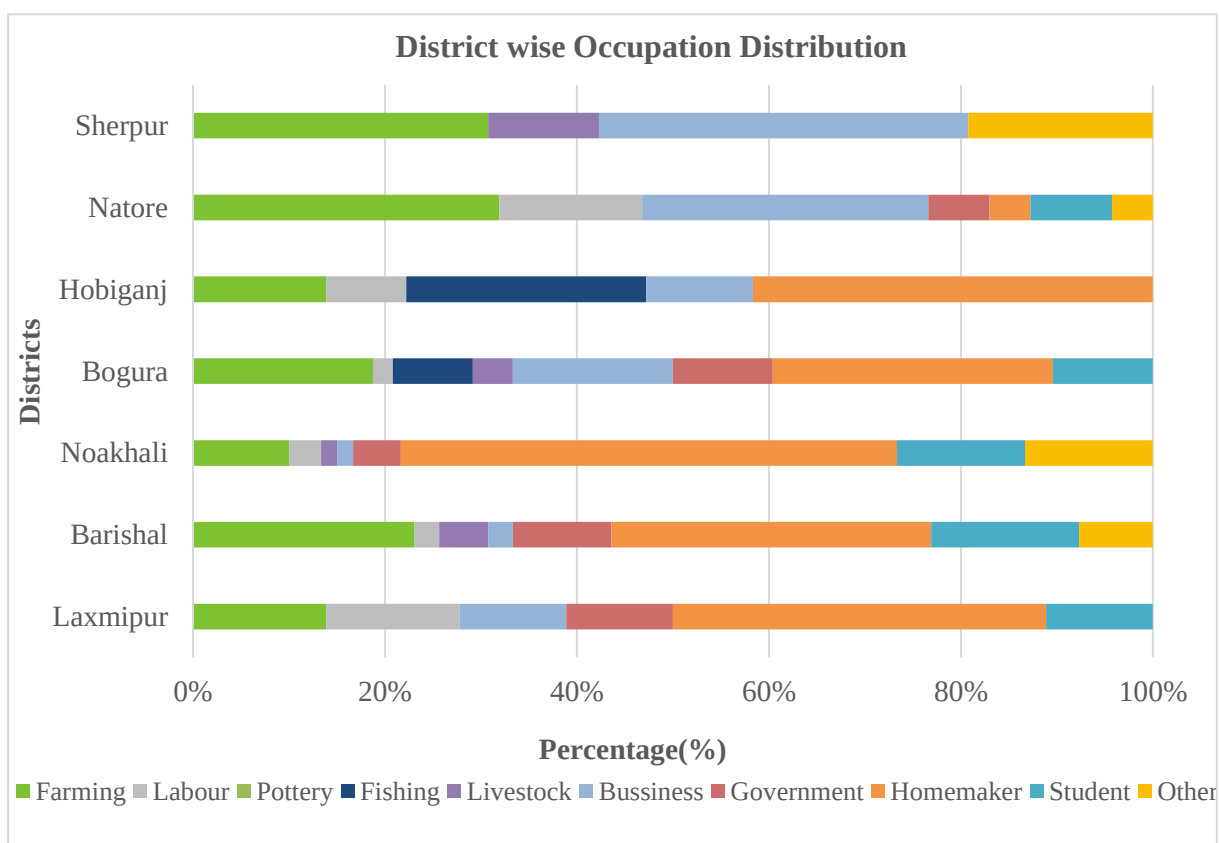


Figure C.4: Graph showing district wise occupation distribution of study area.
Source: Field Survey,2023

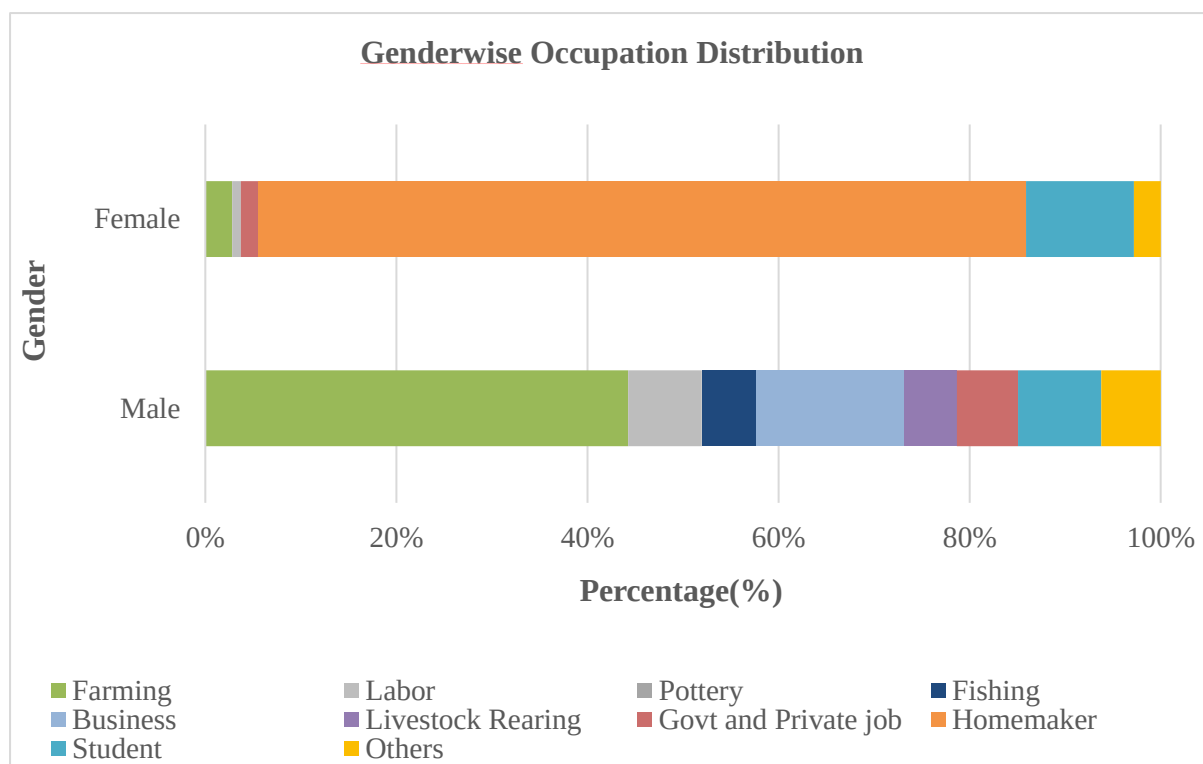


Figure C.5: Graph showing gender wise occupation distribution of study area.
Source: Field Survey,2023

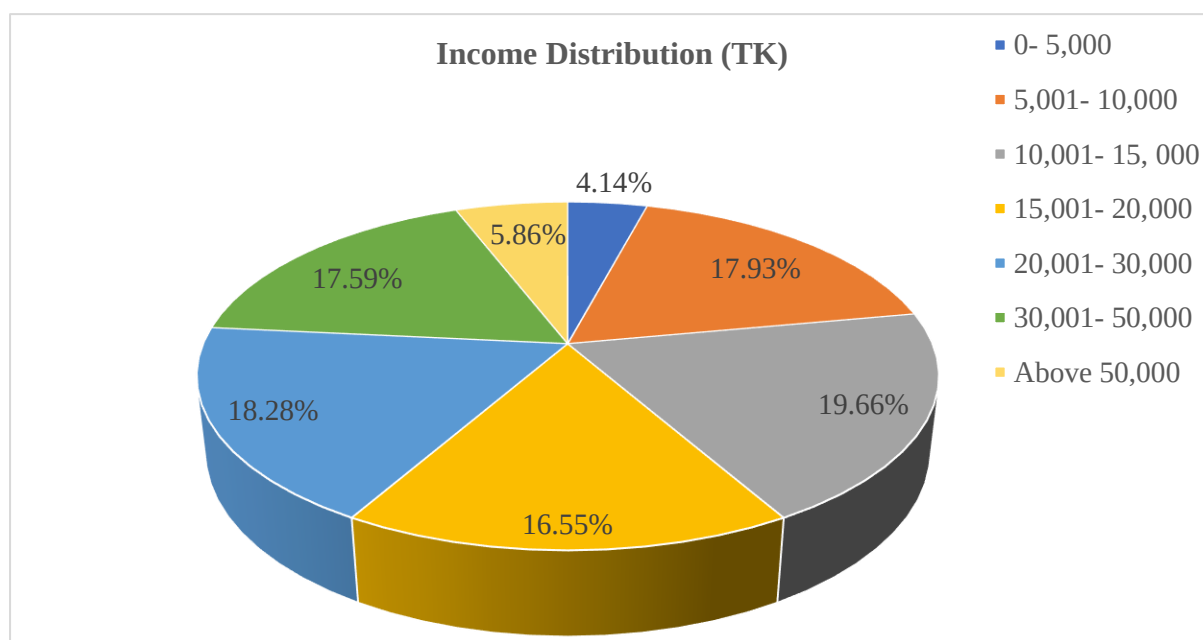


Figure C.6: Graph showing income distribution of study area. Source: Field Survey,2023

Table- C.1: Table showing community facilities available in each study area (Upazilla)

Upazilla		Baniachong	Gurudaspur	Ramganj	Companiganj	Nalitabari	Adamdighi	Wazirpur
School		180	76	158	125	197	120	236
College		4	5	6	4	2	9	14
Health Centre	Upazila Health Complex	1 Bed 31	1 Bed 50	1 Bed 31	1 Bed 50	1 Bed 31	1 Bed 31	1 Bed 50
	Clinic	1	4				6	
	Union health centre		5	8			6	9
Rural Market		35	20	24	20	31	14	40
Growth Centre		5	6	5	4	4	5	5
Religious facilities	Mosque	230	368	242	242	287	274	583
	Temple	85	28	21	39	38	72	138

(Source: National Portal, 2023)

Appendix D

Table D.1 Summary of FGD and KII:

Framework	❑ Decision Making: • Government decisions are usually top-down, driven by civil servants • NGOs involve various stakeholders, promoting a bottom-up approach for diverse perspectives. • CBOs prioritize community involvement for accurate representation of needs and priorities. ❑ Funding: • Governments fund initiatives through tax revenue, grants, and borrowing. • NGOs rely on aid, donations, and income-generating activities. • CBOs prioritize community involvement for accurate representation of needs and priorities. ❑ Evaluation and Monitoring: • Government agencies monitor activities by officers visiting fields and gathering feedback. • NGOs assess progress through surveys and interviews. • CBOs involve community members in program evaluations to gather their insights and perspectives.
Livelihood and Employment	❑ Agriculture: • Officers of agriculture office they , claimed that provide allowance or loan to poor farmers and also training facility. • In reality from FGD and questionnaire, we didn't found implication of these projects. • In Natore, people farm commercially but in off season, people become unemployed and want industries. Or allowance/ loan for livestock harvesting. • Modern tech in agriculture in expensive. So, farmers want to in shares or through cooperatives. • Farmers want fair market system without middle-man to have fair price.

	☐ Employment: • Vast young generation is suffering through unemployment problems reported in FGD but no major employment initiatives are seen. Lack of employment opportunities encourages migration trend and reluctant to avail high education in some areas. • KII claimed that they provide regular training and loan facilities but satisfaction of training center has lowest .
Empowerment	☐ Women empowerment is hardly executed at field level. ☐ Though private - public all authorities have claimed that they emphasize the matter. ☐ The women's welfare office claimed to provide long training for self employment. ☐ But women do not want to work outside. Their perspective is male handles outside.
Basic Facilities and Infrastructure	☐ Health: • Though we found projects related to health in most upazilas, some upazila people get at least minimum treatment in upazila health complex. and have to go private clinic or district health complex. • Vaccination program is satisfactory among people. • In Natore and Habiganj , upazila health officer highlighted some challenges like absence of hospitals, and although a community clinic is present, lack of medical professionals., low budget allocation and digital medical instruments. • . Particularly, women encounter significant challenges during emergencies related to pregnancy. ☐ Infrastructure: • Majority of investment allocated to construction, neglecting maintenance from KII. From FGD, local also said low quality of

	construction work damages road condition easily.. Moreover maximum initiatives are taken infrastructure sector but poor satisfaction level depicts the same ☐ Locational Specific Need: • Haor area like Habiganj suffer by shortage of drinking water during few months in year. • Disaster prone area like Barisal , govt do not pay much attention for disaster. BO mainly handle disaster preparedness.
Community Participation	☐ From questionnaire , most people know about NGO and govt initiatives from informed by others. People participation level is mostly limited to inform level. ☐ But in KII, they claim to perform meetings, yard gathering and involve public in implementation. ☐ In contrast in partnership and CBO projects, people are informed by direct meeting, yard gatherings and people are involved in all levels
Challenges	☐ In most areas ,corruption and delay are challenges. Govt officials claimed that they finish most projects in time but have a lack of manpower. ☐ NGOs have funding problem. But NGO officials in KII claimed that they have enough funding and search new clients. ☐ In partnership projects, most people could not find any challenges. But from KII, some prefer partnership as it increases manpower and easy to reach people whereas some think govt is corrupted and NGO maintain their standpoint. ☐ CBO project go through co-ordination problem among participants.

Table D.2: Summary of Rural Development Initiatives:

Upazilla	KII Authority	Initiatives
Ramganj(Laxmipur)	Women Welfare Directory	• Kishor-Kishori Club
	Upazilla Health Complex	• Vaccination (EPI) • Antenatal Care (ANC)
	BRAC	• poverty alleviation, women's empowerment, and financial inclusion, providing small loans • TB screening and diagnosis
Wazirpur (Barisal)	Union Parishad Chairman	1. Women Empowerment • VGD program providing rice (50kg) for 2 years. • Allowance for pregnant women and old. • For widows and women without husbands (600 tk). 2. Infrastructure development
	Upazila Women's Affairs	• Income Generating Activities (IGA) • Kishore-Kishori Club
	Upazila Social Service	• Rural Mother Club (RMC) • Improvement in the Living Standard for Marginalized People

	UDDIPAN	• Micro-credit • Swastho Apa program • Bangabandhu Scholarship
	BRAC	• Micro- credit • Ultra Poor Graduation (UPG) • Provides legal advice to tortured female
	CBO	• Embankment Construction • Road Construction • Flood Management and Irrigation
Companyganj (Noakhali)	Local Government Engineering Department	• Infrastructure Development of Government Schools Project • Village Road Rehabilitation Project • Flood & Disaster Damaged Rural Road • Multipurpose Disaster Shelter Project (MDSP) • Cyclone Amphan & Flood Damage Rural
	Education Engineering Department	• Development Project of Non-government Secondary School

		• Development Project of Government Secondary School • SECONDARY EDUCATION SECTOR INVESTMENT PROGRAM (SESIP)
	Bangladesh Agriculture Development Corporation	• Small Irrigation Development Project of Feni, Noakhali and Laxmipur District • Waterlogging Removal and Increasing Crop • Production by Complimentary Irrigation
	Department of Public Health Engineering	• Wash Block Construction in Primary School • Deep Tube well Installation in Different Unions • Community Latrine Construction
	Department Of Disaster Management	• Shelter Center • Employment Generation Programme for the Poorest, EGPP
	Upazila Agriculture Office	• Seed production project • Family nutrition garden project • Oil type crop project

	Proshika	• Microcredit for small and medium enterprise • Training for cow fattening and livestock rearing
	Uddipon	Microfinancing project Health sector by conducting diabetes checks and providing tablets
Adamdighi (Bogra)	Upazilla Parishad	• Provisioning sewing machines • Distributing wheelchairs
	Local Government Engineering Department	• LCS (Labor Contracting Society) and • RERMP-3 (Rural Employment and Road Maintenance Programme-3)
	BRAC	• Pukur Khonon Project • Social Forestry
	Grameen Bank	• Microfinance • Nobin Uddokta
Baniacong (Habiganj)	Child Sensitive Social Protection in Bangladesh	The Child Sensitive Social Protection (CSSP)
	Upazila Fisheries	• Train the fisherman for efficient and profitable fishing

		• Ektee Bari Ektee Khamar project
Gurudaspur (Natore)	social service Parishad	• Rehabilitating Acid victims and disabled people • Helping refugees • Funds/allowance for elderly, widow, disabled, ethnic minority, education funds, • orphanages, hospitals, cancer, kidney, liver patients etc.
	Upazila administration	• No Hungry people (Example: TCB minimum price) • Provision of drinking water for all (Tube well, submersible pump) • Repairing of roads by LGED

	Agriculture office	• Motivating and encouraging farmers through incentives (providing seeds, pesticides, funds etc.) • Exhibitions to encourage farmers. Provides free seeds, chemicals, irrigations • facilities to the farmers • Training of farmers regarding technology. (Transportation cost, honorarium are provided)
	Grameen Bank	• Microfinance related projects • Beggar loan - might give back, might not (no liability) • Higher education loans, incentives for education (5 years no interest)
	BRAC	• Deals with Pulmonary Tuberculosis cooperated with government • Checkup for pregnant women